

Fuzzy Wuzz

A LITTLE BROWN BEAR
OF THE SIERRAS



ALLEN CHAFFEE

Fuzzy Wuzz

A LITTLE BROWN BEAR
OF THE SIERRAS



ALLEN CHAFFEE

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Fuzzy-Wuzz, a little brown bear of the Sierras

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Fuzzy-Wuzz, a little brown bear of the Sierras

Author: Allen Chaffee

Illustrator: Peter DaRu

Release date: February 1, 2023 [eBook #69923]

Language: English

Original publication: United States: Milton Bradley Company, 1922

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/69923

Credits: Charlene Taylor, Krista Zaleski and the Online Distributed Proofreading Team at <https://www.pgdp.net> (This file was produced from images generously made available by The Internet Archive/American Libraries.)

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK FUZZY-WUZZ,
A LITTLE BROWN BEAR OF THE SIERRAS ***



**Dapple would strike at her with her
forefeet.**

—Page 29

FUZZY-WUZZ

A Little Brown Bear of the Sierras

By

A L L E N C H A F F E E

Author of "Unexplored," "Lost River," "Twinkly Eyes, the Little Black Bear," "Trail and Tree Top," etc.

Illustrated by

P E T E R D A R U

MILTON BRADLEY COMPANY
SPRINGFIELD - - - MASSACHUSETTS

Copyright, 1922
BY MILTON BRADLEY COMPANY
Springfield, Massachusetts

All rights reserved

Bradley Quality Books

PRINTED IN UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

To
M. M. Soule

INTRODUCTION

A LITTLE brown bear, no bigger than a house cat, that the Ranger found near drowning, is brought up with the orphaned fawn his children tamed, a rascally young burro, a ring-tailed cat, an owl, a tame canary, and a valiant yellow pup.

The scene is laid in the high Sierras, where trout-filled streams cascade down fragrant cedar slopes.

The author has turned natural science into story form. With the enterprising bear cub, we meet pine squirrels and painted chipmunks, the pika of the snow-clad peaks and the rattler of the sun-baked low-lands, the weasel and the wapiti, and have at least a glimpse of the cougar and the coyote.

CONTENTS

CHAPTER	PAGE
I MOTHER BROWN BEAR	<u>1</u>
II THE CINNAMON CUB	<u>5</u>
III THE YOUNG SCREECH OWL	<u>8</u>
IV WITH THE RANGER'S CHILDREN	<u>12</u>
V FUZZY RUNS AWAY	<u>16</u>
VI THE COYOTES	<u>19</u>
VII THE SPOTTED FAWN	<u>22</u>
VIII WILD PLAYMATES	<u>27</u>
IX THE HUNTER	<u>31</u>
X TINY FOLK AND THEIR TROUBLES	<u>34</u>
XI CHUCK AND CHIPPER	<u>38</u>
XII MOTHER CHIPMUNK'S ADVENTURE	<u>43</u>
XIII THE HOME UNDER THE ROCK	<u>46</u>
XIV THE CACHE	<u>50</u>
XV THE PINE NUTS	<u>54</u>
XVI FUZZY-WUZZ PLAYS FATE	<u>58</u>
XVII BUCKY, THE BURRO	<u>62</u>
XVIII "AS STUBBORN AS A MULE"	<u>66</u>
XIX THE PINTO PONY	<u>70</u>
XX THE PACK-HORSE TRIP	<u>75</u>
XXI WHEN THE WORLD TURNED WHITE	<u>79</u>
XXII THE RING-TAILED CAT	<u>83</u>
XXIII THE BABY CANARY	<u>87</u>

XXIV “JEST AN ORNERY PUP”	<u>92</u>
XXV A REGULAR DOG	<u>97</u>
XXVI CHUMS	<u>101</u>
XXVII PRETTY PAWS, THE PINE SQUIRREL	<u>105</u>
XXVIII THE RATTLESNAKE DEN	<u>110</u>
XXIX MOTHER BROWN BEAR AND THE BULL	<u>115</u>
XXX PIKA OF THE PEAKS	<u>121</u>
XXXI FUZZY AND THE WEASEL	<u>125</u>
XXXII WAPITI	<u>129</u>
XXXIII DAPPLE DISAPPEARS	<u>133</u>
XXXIV DAPPLE’S SECRET	<u>136</u>
XXXV OLD FRIENDS	<u>139</u>

FUZZY-WUZZ

CHAPTER I

MOTHER BROWN BEAR

THE stars, twinkling like diamonds on a black velvet sky, looked down that night on a tender sight. A huge brown bear lay in the mouth of her cave in the rocks above the falls, nuzzling her babies to sleep.

A crafty old coyote also watched, his yellow eyes gleaming murderously at the tiny balls of fur. Soon, he told himself, the mother would have to go in search of her own supper, leaving the cubs asleep in the den. He licked his chops at the thought.

The littlest cub looked so tender and helpless! His cinnamon-brown fur, that matched the red-brown soil and the red-brown trunks of the pines, was still as fuzzy as a kitten's.

But it just happened that the cubs were not left alone that night. As the last red flush had faded from the peak of Red Top, their mother had had an unexpected feast. A Forest Ranger, with his camp outfit on a burro, had stopped at the foot of the falls to cook a string of trout and other good things, and had then pushed on up the trail to the hot springs, where he had work to do.

The mother bear had scarcely waited till the man was out of sight before she had gobbled up the fish heads, the left-over flapjacks, the bacon rind, everything,—while the burro, hobbled with a rope about his heels, had snorted in alarm and browsed as far away as he could get.

Now she could stay at home, at least till daybreak,—for her clever nose had caught the message that the breeze carried her, from that sneaking little yellow wild dog, and no coyote was going to steal a march on her! Her teeth gleamed in a snarl as she thought of the danger to her unweaned cubs.

Had she seen more of men, she would have thought it strange that the Ranger should leave his burro and pack behind. But this was in the high

Sierras, a steep mountainside where few men passed, and she had seen little of the strange creatures who always walked on their hind legs and made mysterious fires.

In one way she was different from most bears. She had three cubs instead of only two. It was about all she could keep track of. Of course they were obedient youngsters. Wild babies have to be, if they are to survive.

When their mother took the trail to the river, they followed her in single file, the biggest cub first, wee Fuzzy-Wuzz at the end of the procession. If she heard something she did not understand, and rose to her hind legs to listen, the three little bears stood up the same way, pricking their ears and trying to hear what she heard. If she sniffed at a strange scent, they sniffed; and if she turned and ran, they turned and scrambled after her as fast as their fat legs could carry them.

As it happened, the Ranger returned to camp before the yellow moon had risen from behind the lacework of the pines, and, gathering an armful of springy fir boughs, made his bed by the river, which slapped rhythmically against the rocks in the stealthy quiet.

It was just as he was watering the burro in the chill of sun-up that the shaggy one led her little family forth on an exploring expedition. Plodding along with her nose to the trail, she suddenly heard the sound of footsteps. Instantly, with a startled "Hoof!" she rose to her full height. Instantly three wee mimics rose to their hind legs behind her, breathing each his startled little "Hoof!"

CHAPTER II

THE CINNAMON CUB

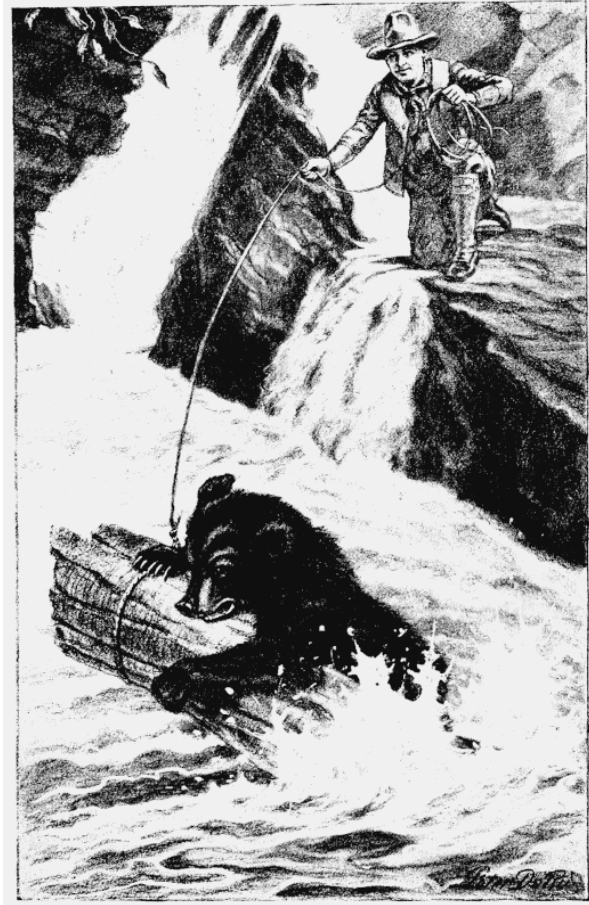
HAD the man been nearer, mother brown bear would have fought to save her cubs. But there was time for escape. As quick as lightning she turned and went racing back to the den, her cubs following at her heels.

This region, so far up the glacier-polished slopes, was so smooth that a burro could hardly walk across it without slipping. As the man turned to stare at the unaccustomed motion in the landscape, the little family was just disappearing behind the boulder that camouflaged the entrance to the den. All but Fuzzy-Wuzz! That fat, furry mite slipped on the smooth granite slope, his short hind legs slid out from under him, and before he could get his balance, he was rolling down, down, too surprised even to call for help. Indeed, the breath was all knocked out of him and he couldn't have squealed had he tried.

The river rolled at the foot of the slope, as green as the woods that bordered it, save where it churned in white foam over the upstanding boulders. The next thing Fuzzy knew, splash! He was in deep water!

He struck out with all fours, like a pup, trying to run through the water. Of course he swam, as all young animals can when they have to. But the water was icy from the melting snows of the surrounding peaks. Worse, the current here above the falls was so strong that soon it was all he could do to keep his nose above water, to say nothing of paddling back to the bank.

Had he let out a frightened whimper now, his mother, with the two remaining cubs to lead safely into the depths of the cave, would not have heard him. The water whirled the wee brown mite this way and that. Choking and spluttering, he was soon too tired to paddle.



Clinging to the raft so mysteriously flung to him, Fuzzy-Wuzz was towed to shore.

At that climactic moment, something solid went floating by his right fore paw, and with all his feeble might he grabbed for it. It was a branch the Ranger had thrown in after him, and the branch was tied to a rope.

Clinging, chilled and strangled, to the raft so mysteriously flung to him, Fuzzy-Wuzz was towed to shore. Had the little bear been caught at any other time, he would have done effective work with his needle-sharp little teeth. But he was so nearly drowned that he could make no protest when the Ranger rubbed him down and fitted a leash to his neck.

A pan of warm canned milk and water won his trust, though the Ranger had to dip his unaccustomed muzzle into the fluid before he saw that the thing to do was to plant both fore paws firmly in the pan and suck with a noise like a little pig.

The Ranger made him a bed on the top of the pack that the burro carried, and tied him so that he couldn't get down,—and there he was shortly snoozing, while the June sun dried his fur, and the trail climbed higher and higher. Life had taken a new turn for young Fuzzy-Wuzz.

CHAPTER III

THE YOUNG SCREECH OWL

ALL that week the wee brown cub rode on the pack the burro carried.

Every few hours the Ranger stopped to give him a panful of warm milk, and at night, when the mountain air turned chill, he snuggled the little bear under the blankets, though he never took him off the leash.

Finally one day they came to a neat log cabin beside a singing creek, where the pines and cedars made spots of shade on the forest floor. The next thing Fuzzy knew, he was inside the cabin, and two delighted man cubs, a boy and a girl, were dancing around him. This was so alarming that he crept inside the Ranger's coat, crying, "Mu-uh! Mu-uh!" in a frightened whimper.

The man cubs were told to keep very, very still and watch. Then Fuzzy was set on the floor before his pan of milk, and after a few minutes, when nothing seemed to hurt him, he drank it thirstily.

After that he went on an exploring expedition. He looked exactly like the brown plush Teddy bear, only larger, for Fuzzy was nearly as large as the cat. The children watched with shining eyes as he poked into every corner of the room, now climbing half way up the screen door, now standing on his fat hind legs under a chair, with his fore paws on the rungs.

"Muh! Muh! M-m-mu-uh!" he wailed every now and again. But no great furry mother came, and at last he decided there was nothing in that den to harm him, not even the children.

Soon what fun they had! The children's mother said he could have bread in his milk, and the children even used to give him bits of the gingerbread that they saved in their pockets. It didn't take long for the fuzzy mite to learn where that gingerbread came from! He would climb all over them, sniffing, sniffing, sniffing, till he found where it was hidden, then claw till

he had found the way into the pocket. These days, he cared more for eating than anything else.

Had Fuzzy been the only pet at the Ranger's cabin, all might have gone smoothly. But he had one rival in the children's affections,—and life was not to be all peace and play for the newcomer.

One rainy day that spring, when the wind had blown a limb off the old pine by the corral, leaving the screech owl's nest exposed to gaze, a wee, soft-feathered fledgling had fallen to the ground and lay there, nearly lifeless from his fall.

The Ranger's son, a curly-pate of nine, had found this downy bird, and had taken him home to warm and feed him. Thus the owl had become a member of the family circle. Clickety-Clack they named him, from his habit of clicking his bill when angry.

Given full freedom of the cabin, he generally perched by day just over the chamber door, on a pair of antlers that hung there for a hat rack.

But when the dusk began to fall Clickety-Clack would come floating down to the mantel shelf, soundless as a shadow on his soft-feathered gray wings. There he would claw at the toys and bits of sewing, the pipe and match box, everything he found there. He was a solemn-looking bird, with his great round eyes, but he liked to play, for all that. His great delight was to be given a sheet of paper to claw into bits.

He was used to much attention, was Clickety-Clack, riding around on the children's shoulders and receiving the dainties offered him with a clawed foot that solemnly conveyed the morsel to his mouth.

For a time Fuzzy-Wuzz paid little attention to Clickety-Clack, as the owl generally slept all day and the cub all night. But one evening he made a sad, sad mistake, did the little bear. As the owl floated down to the hearth rug, Fuzzy made a playful pounce for him. He caught the owl between his fore paws. But as he opened his jaws to take a nip at the feathered back, he got an awful surprise.

CHAPTER IV

WITH THE RANGER'S CHILDREN

F UZZY-WUZZ made a big mistake when he tried to grab that owl. For no sooner had he got a taste of the feathers than Clickety-Clack was after him with beak and claws. When they finally called it off, the hearth rug bore a souvenir of both fur and feathers.

After that the little bear made many a playful, puppy-like dash at his fellow pet, but if ever he came too near, he got as good as he gave. It was tit for tat between them.

True, there were other ways in which Fuzzy managed to have a good time. For instance, he was always on the look-out for a romp in the children's bed, if he was the first one up of a morning. The children's mother objected, until the Ranger suggested a tubbing for the young bear.

This surprising thing,—a tub bath,—happened when Fuzzy-Wuzz had been a member of the Ranger's family for about a week. No sooner did he find himself in the washtubful of warm, soapy water than he struck out vigorously for shore and scrambled over the edge of the tub. This process was repeated till the Ranger took a hand.

In the end Fuzzy-Wuzz emerged as clean a cub as any one could wish, but he stayed clean just until he was put on his leash and allowed to have a run outside. The California dry season had begun, with its dust, and the roly-poly rascal liked nothing better than to roll on his back.

The great trouble with the Ranger's backyard, from Fuzzy's point of view, was that there were no trees to climb. The clothes pole only went so far, and it had no bark and was dreadfully hard to get one's claws into; but Fuzzy used to scramble up and down that clothes pole for all he was worth, pausing each time at the top to sit looking down at the children.

As the weeks flew by and the little bear grew stronger, he longed more and more for the freedom to climb and romp and race the way Mother Nature meant him to. It got to be mighty tiresome to live on the end of a chain or be cooped up in the cabin. He would gaze into the green woods behind the house, and whimper and beg to be let out, but it seemed as if no one understood.

The Ranger was afraid if he let the cub go some big animal would get him. There were great yellow cougars (California lions) in the mountains, and perhaps timber wolves. Besides, even a wildcat could have made way with such a tiny cub, and no telling but that even a pair of coyotes (slinking yellow wild dogs that they are) might harm him. These animals were all afraid to come too near the cabin, for they were cowardly where human beings were concerned. But once let Fuzzy-Wuzz spend a night in the woods and no telling if he would ever see the morning.

Sometimes they could hear the coyotes' bark, or the lion's cry. Then Fuzzy's fur would rise along his spine, and he would huddle closer to the children on the hearth rug. But he never thought of that when the sun shone through the forest and he longed for freedom.

CHAPTER V

FUZZY RUNS AWAY

ONE day it came,—the chance he had been longing for!

Fuzzy-Wuzz was now a four months' cub and much larger than when the Ranger brought him home,—a bear as big as a house cat. He made an armful for the children. And where at first he had been frightened in a world where no great furry mother came to his whimper, he now began to feel as if he could look out for himself.

One day the kitchen door was left ajar. Fuzzy had longed often to go exploring in those green woods that stretched behind the cabin and up the mountainside. Now he simply ran, and ran, and ran, deep into the woods, climbing to the tops of the tallest trees and exploring here and there and everywhere. Here he nibbled at the green, growing things he found on the moist meadows by the spring holes, and there he took tiny cat-naps, all curled up into a warm ball of brown fur.

Not once, all that glorious afternoon, did he think of the coyotes and timber wolves, the lions and the lynxes that might come out of their dens when night came, and hunt squirrels and rabbits, and perhaps stray cubs who were young enough to make tender eating.

Towards sun-down he had an adventure. He met a band of range cattle, and when the foremost cow saw the runaway racing about like a puppy, she took him for a dog and made for him with her horns. It was only by sheer luck that he escaped her lunge. For in his surprise he simply tumbled over backwards. Being near a clump of seedling pines, he rolled right into the thick of them, and the old cow's horns could not reach him.

If any one had advised him what to do when chased by a cow, he could not have given better advice than to get in the midst of a clump of saplings.

His natural fondness for climbing prompted his next move, and again he did the wisest thing. He made straight for the nearest tree and scrambled out of reach. After that the cattle wandered on and left him in peace.

But now the yellow sun no longer gilded the fir trees, and the woods became cool and shadowy. The wind, that all day had blown up the canyon of the creek bed, now turned the other way and blew down into the valley, chilled from the snow-clad mountain peaks. Fuzzy shivered with the cold. A horned owl solemnly boomed “whoo-who, whoo-who!”

By the time the first stars peeped from the blackening sky, he began to shiver from fright as well. For down the canyon came the long-drawn cry of the great, tawny, man-size cat that Californians call the mountain lion.

CHAPTER VI

THE COYOTES

YES, sir! Fuzzy was a mighty frightened bear cub as the cougar's cry chilled the night. He waited in his tree top with straining ears. The cry had ceased, but he dare not climb down, for what might not lurk in the rustling darkness?

Colder and colder grew his airy perch. Fuzzy curled up tight in the crotch of the limb. The lion was away off on the mountainside, and after awhile, when nothing happened, the little bear fell asleep.

His dreams were broken by a weird, wailing, high-pitched howl. He sprang awake in the instant. Peering through the gray darkness of the starry night, he tried to see what was causing that sound.

On a rock ridge half way down the slope stood two animals that any one might have taken for yellow dogs, or perhaps for small-sized wolves. As an actual fact, they were cousins to both dog and wolf. They were coyotes, in search of their supper,—and Fuzzy-Wuzz had not forgotten the old coyote that used to howl below his mother's den.

These coyotes, as it happened, had a family of fourteen little ones hidden in a cave on the hillside. That meant that they had to bring home a great many mice and rabbits for their family, which was still too young to go hunting with them.

Had the Ranger known about them, he would have made an end to them; for many a time they had robbed his chicken house, or harried a new-born colt, for their meat was anything too young and helpless to escape their jaws.

Even had Mother Brown Bear not taught her cubs to keep still and hide when the coyote cried, Fuzzy would have been afraid, with that weird cry in

his ears. As it was, he shivered into a still tighter ball of fur and wished he were back in the Ranger's cabin.

The coyotes must have got his scent with their wonderful doggy noses, as the wind blew down over his tree top to them, for they came circling nearer, and stood howling right up at his hiding-place. But none of the dog family can climb, and the cub was safe.

After awhile they saw a rabbit and went loping after it with all the speed of their slender feet. Again Fuzzy fell asleep, and when he awoke, it was a bar of silver sunlight shining in his eyes that woke him.

The woods now looked as green and peaceful as they had the afternoon before, and it did not seem possible that he could have been so frightened in the night. But he was hungry.

CHAPTER VII

THE SPOTTED FAWN

BACKING down the tree trunk, the runaway began looking about him for something to eat. It was the little bear's first experience at fending for himself. Had he not been taken from his mother, he would have learned from her how to find the fat white grubs that hide under a fallen tree trunk. He might have learned how to dig out a hiding wood mouse, or where to look for roots and berries.

As it was, he sampled a mouthful of bark, but it was no good. He sniffed this way and that through the pine woods, wriggling his nose in the effort to find a breakfast. And he thought of the pan of warm milk that always awaited him after the morning's milking.

The children were just sitting down to their breakfast of oatmeal when a whine and a scratching of claws sounded faintly through the kitchen door. Now they had cried themselves to sleep the night before, thinking their pet was gone.

"It's Fuzzy-Wuzz!" they shouted, tumbling over one another to let him in. My! What a hugging he got! He wriggled and squirmed to get away. Then the Ranger brought in the foaming milk pails, and the prodigal was soon planting both fat fore paws in his feed pan.

After that they never put him on a leash, and Fuzzy never stayed away after dark,—at least not while he was such a tiny cub.

One morning the Ranger found that a mountain lion had been down to the corral. From the footprints he judged that the cows had driven the great cat away with their horns. But there was soon to be a new calf, and he decided to spend that day in hunting the lion.

The California mountain lion is a great, tawny beast as long as a man is tall, and it is fortunate that he is such a coward that he runs when he sees a

human being. For he can fell a deer at one stroke of his great barbed paw.

But he kills sheep and calves every chance he gets, and Uncle Sam asks his Forest Rangers to kill every lion they find.

The Ranger took his gun and started following the footprints the giant cat had left in the dust of the trail as it led up the mountain side. Soon the animal had leapt aside where only a scratch of its claws on a rock here and there told the tale.

By and by the slim, pointed hoof prints of a doe crossed the trail. The Ranger hurried even faster now, for he did not want another deer killed.

A gentle-eyed young doe had sought hiding that morning in a leafy clump of deer brush,—for in the evergreen forests of the Sierras there is little of the thick under-growth that one finds among the oaks and elms and maples of the Eastern woodlands.

This doe had a reason for selecting a good hiding-place, for that very morning twin fawns were born to her, and she had known they must be hidden away where neither lions nor coyotes could find the helpless things.

The fawns had dappled coats, with milk-white spots on their soft, rusty-colored fur; and the doe found a place where the sunlight danced in patches on the rusty-colored earth, and the fawns would not have been noticed had one looked at the very spot,—unless they moved.

Such innocent, soft-eyed babies as they were, these firstlings of the rust-red doe! Like their mother, they had long ears and white tails with black tips. Their long, slender legs were at first too fragile for them to stand, and they lay on the soft moss as she licked their fur, with her wild mother love in her great eyes.

Off on the mountain peak their father, a great, handsome buck with branching antlers, was in retreat, with half-a-dozen other deer, while their horns were in velvet, for this velvety fur that covers the new growth of horn is tender, and the deer brush of the lower slopes would hurt it.

But alas for the wild mother, who would willingly die fighting for her little ones! At the very moment that she lay nuzzling them so happily, the giant cat was crouched along the limb of a fir tree watching, with yellow

eyes blinking hungrily. The way the wind blew, no taint of the lion reached her nostrils, and she had no warning.

The mountain lion had been unsuccessful in his last night's hunt; he had wandered miles in search of prey. Suddenly gathering all fours beneath him, he had made one powerful leap at the doe. At this moment the Ranger, hurrying along his trail, sighted the tawny form and sent a bullet through its heart.

But so powerful had been the great cat's leap that it did not stop even then, but still clutching the doe, it went sliding and rolling down the hillside till it crashed over a ledge,—and one of the fawns with them.

It was too late to save the others, but the Ranger took the remaining fawn in his arms and carried it home to his children. Thus Dapple, the fawn, became a fellow member of Fuzzy's household.



**The giant cat was crouched along
the limb of a fir tree.**

CHAPTER VIII

WILD PLAYMATES

HAD the bear cub and the fawn been older, they would never have been friends; but these were both such babies that the little bear much preferred his milk to venison, and the fawn did not know to be afraid.

Their strange friendship might not last, as they grew older, but for the time there was peace between them.

The fawn had to be brought up on a bottle, and the children loved it first for its very helplessness.

As Dapple grew stronger, her long, slim legs developed the most amazing ability to jump. She followed the children around like a pup, for they were the only parents she knew. And if they became separated, she would go leaping after them with great, graceful leaps that carried her straight over the bushes.

They used to like to run and hide from her, just for the fun of seeing her come bounding after them. She could overtake them in a foot race, too. She enjoyed a game of tag as much as they did, and everywhere the children went, the fawn would follow after.

But though Fuzzy-Wuzz understood that Dapple was under the children's protection, the young rascal loved to chase her. He never had the slightest chance of overtaking her, for his short, fat legs and round, flat feet were not built for speed. But sometimes he got her cornered and woofed at her, as a puppy would a calf.

At such times she learned to take refuge in the corral. Leaping lightly over the three-log fence, she would trip her way into the midst of the cattle, who would lower their horns the instant the little bear came near.

No matter if Dapple were lying down when Fuzzy-Wuzz grew mischievous, she took her afternoon nap with all four feet under her, and

when she made up her mind to go, she rose like a Jack-in-the-box, and away she leapt with a whistle, like a bit of thistle-down.

After a time Dapple found still another way to defend herself, when Fuzzy-Wuzz grew mischievous. Her slender hoofs were sharp as knives, and she would rear up on her hind legs and strike at him with her fore feet. He kept his distance.

Sometimes a deer will fight a snake that way.

Now Dapple learned to follow the children everywhere they went. Through the corral and into the woods, and even up the porch steps, would she trip after them. Once she even came into the cabin, and she would have every time, had the Ranger's wife permitted.

She was like Mary's little lamb. But there were no schools in this wilderness. The children's mother taught them to read and figure, and their father told them about the trees and flowers and birds, the rocks and clouds, and read them books about the great world outside their Sierras. That way, lessons were mostly play. Their playmates were the two wild children, Dapple and Fuzzy-Wuzz.

CHAPTER IX

THE HUNTER

ONE morning a party of huntsmen stopped at the Ranger's cabin. It was open season for deer, and they meant to make the most of those few weeks by shooting what the law allowed them.

Fuzzy-Wuzz had to wear a red bow on his neck these days, so that the huntsmen would not mistake him for a wild bear. For it was open season all the year around for bears, and a hunter loves nothing better than to kill a cub and have bear steak for breakfast. But Dapple wore no collar, as it was against the law to kill fawns at any time of the year.

The children had been playing tag with Dapple in the woods when they fell asleep in the sunshine of an open hillside. Dapple, too, took a nap nearby, but instead of lying right out in the open, as they did, her instinct told her it was safer under the dappled shade of a clump of bushes.

One of the huntsmen, peering over the brow of the hill, saw a little movement in Dapple's clump of bushes, as Dapple awoke and began cropping the leaves. Thinking it was a porcupine that had set the bushes swaying (and not being sportsman enough to make sure), he fired.

Dapple gave a scream of pain, and went bounding away on three legs. The children, thus awakened, stared after her, then started to follow her dainty hoof prints. Soon they noticed drops of blood on the stones.

At the same time the huntsman, seeing the children, came on the run. "Oh, I say!" he called, "I hope I didn't hurt any one?"

"You've killed Dapple," sobbed the little girl.

"You've shot Dapple!" shouted the boy. And to his sister, "I'd like to shoot HIM in the leg, and see how HE likes it!"

"Who's 'Dapple'?" gasped the huntsman, alarmed.

“She’s our tame fawn!” yelled the boy angrily.

“I’m so sorry,” apologized the huntsman. “I thought it was a porcupine.”

“Oh, then you didn’t mean to do it,” forgave the little girl.

It was decided that the huntsman had better not go with the children lest he frighten the fawn still further away.

“Dapple! Come, Dapple!” they called gently, as they traced the staggering footprints. They came upon the little creature lying on her side. Tenderly the boy carried her home in his arms, and the Ranger removed the bullet and bound the wound up properly.

Such an appealing invalid as Dapple made, with her great, reproachful eyes, that Fuzzy felt himself neglected. The day came, though, when the wounded leg was well. That day Dapple was allowed to follow them into the cabin, and even Fuzzy-Wuzz gave her a lick with his warm, moist tongue.

CHAPTER X

TINY FOLK AND THEIR TROUBLES

ONE thing that always interested the little bear was the robin who used to bring her fat fledglings, nearly as big as herself, to the Ranger's lawn.

She had made her big clay nest on a beam of the porch, where the young birds would be sheltered from wind and rain. The young robins would flop to the ground, when she urged them, then hop around after Mrs. Red-breast as she pulled grubs and worms from the ground for them. They soon learned to look for the crumbs the children threw them. Fuzzy would watch, and sometimes make a playful dash at them; but at such times they would suddenly find they could fly out of reach.

Another time a humming-bird flew in through the open window and began sipping nectar from the bunch of wild flowers the children had brought for the dining-table. Tiniest of birds, he made as much noise as any airplane that size could have made. The children held as still as mice while they watched.

One day Fuzzy was put on his leash just as some one left a bunch of grapes on the porch rail, for the Ranger had ridden down to the valley settlement for supplies the day before, and brought home a basket of the luscious fruit. My, how he wanted those grapes! But he could not reach them. There was nothing left to do but to watch the young robins flying, for their tails had grown longer, and so they could keep their balance better in the air.

When he looked back at the grapes again, an orange-breasted oriole was plunging his beak thirstily into a grape. He only ate one this time, and flew away. But soon he was back again, eating another grape. Fuzzy watched anxiously. Again the oriole came, and the little bear watched the grapes

disappear, one by one. When the children finally let him off his leash, there was nothing left of those grapes but the stems.

Never mind, there were lizards and field mice all about the place. This afternoon, while the reddening sun still shone warm on the boulders, the tiny gray lizards with beady eyes on the alert for flies darted hither and thither among the gray rocks. The instant they saw Fuzzy watching, they would freeze motionless, or rise on their crooked legs till their orange breasts showed, watch him till he came too near, then race into a crack between two stones.

Fuzzy spent much time chasing field mice, or digging them out of their tunnels. One night the family was just sitting down to supper when a clawing at the door announced that Fuzzy wanted to come in. Coming proudly straight to the little girl, Fuzzy laid his catch in her lap. It was a fat field mouse!

The young mouse had not been hurt by Fuzzy's jaws, and the instant he found himself free, he leaped to the table and raced across it and away, and not even Fuzzy could find him after that. But the next morning he was sitting trembling in the mouse trap in the pantry, which was one of these round wire affairs that has a hole on top that lets a mouse get in, but won't let him out.

How he trembled when the little girl found him. Fuzzy watched to see if the prisoner would be given to him to dispose of. But no, the little girl took the trap out into the woods and there opened the door and let the mouse find a hiding-place in the woods where he belonged.

CHAPTER XI

CHUCK AND CHIPPER

THE little brown bear spent much of his first summer chasing chipmunks, but these squirrel-like orange and black striped fellows were too quick for Fuzzy-Wuzz.

The pretty creatures lived along the rock ledges and manzanita bushes that surrounded the Ranger's cabin. Chuck and Chipper were two young chipmunks who had been born that spring. Now their mother had a second brood and left them pretty much to themselves.

My, what fun they had playing tag and stuffing their cheeks with everything good to eat they could find! Their cheeks were built like pockets and extended away down the sides of their necks. All the long, sunny days they explored the interesting world in which they found themselves,—a world of good things to eat.

So tiny and mouselike were they that Fuzzy would have liked a taste of them, even if there were plenty of green things to eat, but the awkward, flat-footed, four months' cub could not catch them.

The children, too, tried to capture a chipmunk, just for the fun of holding it in their hands for a minute. The boy had a cracker box that he placed upside down on the ground, then propped it open a crack with a stick. To this stick he tied a long string. Strewing the ground under the box with peanuts, he waited behind a tree till a chipmunk came and began stuffing his cheeks with the nuts. Then he jerked the string, and the box came down and made a prisoner of him. It was Chuck, who went about all day with his cheerful "chuck, chuck, chuck!"

The boy, holding his cloth hat in readiness, lifted the box a crack and Chuck dashed from under, but only to find himself in the hat crown. The next thing he knew, the boy was stroking his back with one finger. Did he bite? Not the least little bit in the world. Chuck never tries to fight any one.

His safety lies in running away when danger threatens. He only cowered down, quaking, with fear, his warm, furry sides panting hotly.

Until he could make a cage, the boy tethered him out on a leash, on a string as long as the cabin kitchen, and left him with a handful of peanuts. But the prisoner was too frightened to eat. He was even more so when he was turned loose in the cracker box, across the open side of which the boy had tacked a piece of screen wire. He only crept to the darkest corner, under a lettuce leaf, and wondered if he were ever again to go racing through the green woods in the sunshine.

The boy did not mean to keep him a prisoner, but the little captive did not understand.

Curiously Chuck's brother, Chipper, peered at him from the top of a stump. "I told you not to go into that box," he chippered in a frightened chirp. "Now what are you going to do?" Just then he saw the little girl coming, and he whisked away under a stone.

All would have been well, she would not even have looked his way, had he not lost his nerve at the very moment she was passing, and begun his frightened chippering. Quick as a flash she had thrown her sunbonnet over rocks and all, and the next thing he knew, she had put him in the box with Chuck.

"Well, at least there are two of us," Chuck tried to find a bright spot in the situation. And he felt so much better that he began to eat and drink. Then the night grew chilly, and they wadded the paper with which the box was carpeted into a sort of hay stack of paper wads, and burrowed inside it, all cuddled together into a ball to keep warm.

But Chipper did not have the heart to eat. Three days later he was so feeble from lack of food and exercise that he could hardly crawl. The boy, seeing this, opened the cage door and let them out. After all, he told his sister, they had not been half so much fun as when they had been racing mischievously all over the place.

CHAPTER XII

MOTHER CHIPMUNK'S ADVENTURE

THE Ranger was leading his horse down a steep trail one day, the dust rising yellowly in the noon-day calm, when he came to an inviting bit of shade and took out his lunch. For a time he munched his cheese sandwiches with his mind on his work. His horse neighed thirstily, and he led him to the spring, which trickled from the hillside.

As he turned back, he saw a chipmunk nervously gathering up his crumbs. Standing so still that he hardly breathed, so as not to frighten her, he watched while she darted forward, stopped to study him with her beady eyes, then dared a few steps farther. At last she picked up a big cracker crumb, and taking it in her handlike fore paws, began nibbling as if she were starved.

A slight movement on the Ranger's part sent her instantly to her hole, but in a few minutes she was back again, eating ravenously and stuffing her cheeks with crumbs to take home. But the crumbs had all been cracker. The Ranger now threw her a morsel of cheese. This she found delicious. Never in all her life had she tasted anything so good. And it seemed as if she never could get enough to eat these days, for she had a family of wee baby chipmunks that she nursed as a cat does her kittens.

Next the Ranger held a piece of cheese between his thumb and finger. She wriggled her nose longingly, and hesitated, darting forward a few inches, now stopping in affright at what she had done, then getting up courage for another step.

Long minutes the Ranger waited, with that inviting bit of cheese held out to her at arm's-length. So timid was she that he dared not even turn his head. Closer, closer she crept, till at last she could just get a frightened nibble. My, how good it was! Closer still she came, till she was eating it out

of his hand. She ate until he could feel her warm, furry nose against his finger.

Making a sudden grab, he closed his hand around her. He hadn't meant to, but the temptation had been too much. He wanted first to stroke her silky fur. Then he thought there could be no harm in taking her home in his pocket to show the children. For he had been away when they caught Chuck and Chipper. Of course he didn't know about her babies.

Mother Chipmunk gave one shrill squeak of despair. Then she was buttoned fast in the Ranger's pocket, and he was riding farther and farther away from those wee, helpless babes of hers in the hole under the rock.

CHAPTER XIII

THE HOME UNDER THE ROCK

BUT what of the babies left behind, when Mother Chipmunk rode away in the Ranger's pocket?

From an entrance hole under a rock just large enough to let her in, and not large enough for a weasel, Mother Chipmunk had built a branching tunnel that led for many feet under the pine needles of the forest floor. Three feet under-ground was the nursery cave, as big around as a dinner plate, all softly lined with dry leaves and moss.

Out of the main tunnel opened a smaller cave in which refuse was placed. There were also three storage caves or pantries, where in winter Mother Chipmunk kept her nuts and berries, dried grasshoppers and other delicacies for the long months when it is white and cold out of doors.

Just now the nursery cave was occupied by four of the most cunning baby chipmunks that ever were,—helpless at this age, without teeth. When Mother Chipmunk washed them, she would stand on her hind legs and take one up on her arms so that she could smooth its fur with her tongue.

Now these helpless babies would starve to death, she told herself. She must find a way to escape, if her life depended on it. And she must find it quickly, or she could never travel back all those miles the Ranger was taking her.

She struggled and struggled, there in the Ranger's pocket. But he had fastened it shut. On they went, jogging slowly down the rocky trail. She couldn't see a thing, but she felt the rhythmic jolting at each step of the horse. At last it seemed as if she must be standing on her head. The Ranger had leapt to the ground, and was stooping to drink at a spring. As he bent, the pocket came unbuttoned. Out she squeezed, straight into the icy water.

“Well, I never!” exclaimed the Ranger, as she struck out with all her might, swimming across the pool till she could scramble to shore. Hiding under a stone till she was sure he had gone, she started racing back along the way she had come. She reached home to find her babies crying for her.

Chipmunks are easy to tame, if one does not try to keep them prisoner. Before the summer was over, the children had Chuck and Chipper so that they came around every meal time for something good to eat, and if the window was left open, they would come right into the cabin for it. Once they nearly buried themselves by jumping into the cold ashes of the fireplace.

They used to drink from the water pail when it was full enough for them to reach the water from the rim. One day Chipper reached too far, fell in, and had to swim for it. But when he reached the side of the granite pail, it was too smooth for his claws and he could not get out. The children found him near drowning.

Now Fuzzy had a real grievance, for always before, anything the children had in their pockets to eat was for him. Now Chuck and Chipper searched them first. Fuzzy was more eager than ever to catch the impudent rascals.

CHAPTER XIV

THE CACHE

CHUCK and Chipper were mighty busy chipmunks, filling their cache, —to use the Western term that rhymes with to-day, meaning a hiding-place for food supplies.

The season was short, here in the high Sierras. Ordinarily it snowed as late as May, and as early as October. By the last of August one expected frost to tint the mountain sides. Day followed perfect, sunny day, and night succeeded cool, star-strewn night without a hint of rain; but Chuck and Chipper knew that before the moon was full again, the snow would be silvering the pine trees,—promise of the fifteen-foot drifts to come.

They must have enough in their cache to live on till spring.

Chipmunks do not hibernate in the way that bears do. They sleep a good deal, but they do not go into an all-winter sleep, and when they wake, there in their caves away under-ground where the cold cannot reach them, they must eat.

Everywhere among the brush and fallen timber and along the rock ledges they searched for food to store away for winter. Racing briskly forth each morning, as soon as the sun began to slant warmingly through the fir trees, Chuck and Chipper vied with each other to see which could harvest the most nuts. And Fuzzy-Wuzz vied with both to see if he could catch them.

Always they were too alert for him. Their black, beady eyes would spy him out, no matter how softly he came padding along, and then they would climb into the top of some bush he could not climb and scold him and mock at him with their bird-like chirp.

Wild gooseberries were one of their favorite foods,—as they were the little bear's, for they could bite off the prickles, and Fuzzy didn't mind

them.

They also collected thistle seed in their cheek pockets, to say nothing of thimble berries, dogwood seed, and other seeds and berries. But where Fuzzy envied them was when it came to pine nuts. Every pine cone, from the yellow pine that grew so tall, to the dwarfed nut pine that the Indians love, is full of seeds. But the cones are also covered with sharp thorns, and so long as the cones were green, the nuts were safe from the little bear. He would have to wait till they turned brown and opened of their own accord.

But Chuck and Chipper had no such trouble. They could nibble the cone apart and get at the sweet kernels as easily as anything. Fuzzy used to watch them enviously. Then an idea came to him. He watched narrowly as the chipmunks filled their cheeks and scuttled away to their under-ground store-rooms.

Sniffing and snuffing this way and that, along the way they had gone, his wonderful nose finally told him just where their cache was located. Digging down about three feet, he scratched the roof off it while Chipper chucked wrathfully and Chuck chippered in his fright.

What a find for the bear cub! Fully a peck of the delicious pine nuts lay before him,—and how he did feast! How his little black eyes twinkled at thought that he had outwitted the impudent things!

But for Chuck and Chipper it meant that half their harvest work was gone for nothing, and winter now too near for them to gather more. Then Chipper had a big idea.

CHAPTER XV

THE PINE NUTS

“**I**T is the queerest thing!” exclaimed the Ranger’s wife, “what can have become of those pine nuts I was saving for Christmas. I had fully a peck in that basket on the top shelf.” She looked doubtfully at Fuzzy-Wuzz.

“The cub never could have done it,” the Ranger said. “If he had climbed up there, he would have knocked down a lot of stuff.”

“No, but what can have become of the nuts? There isn’t a sign of mice, either. And we never have a human thief, away up here in the mountains. Besides, what a funny thing it would be for a thief just to take the pine nuts and nothing else.”

“The thief must be some one of our furry friends, some one who is especially fond of nuts,” suggested the Ranger.

“There is a tiny hole gnawed in the wall up there. I thought it might be a mouse, but they always leave some sign.”

“Let’s see, now, if there aren’t some footprints to tell the story,” and the Ranger climbed up on the window sill and began peering about with a lighted match. “Ho, ho!” he called.

For there, faintly outlined by the dust, was a footprint like that of a tiny squirrel,—the print of a long, hind foot, with its five delicate toe marks. And on the edge of the hole the Ranger’s sharp eyes had spied a hair,—a single hair of some one’s orange colored fur.

“It’s a chipmunk, and he must have sat up here on his hind legs to sample a nut before he stuffed his cheeks. But imagine how many trips he must have had to make to carry away all those nuts!”

“Perhaps there was more than one.”

“That’s right. But there are so many tracks running through the dust that this is the only clear one I see. Must have been made just this morning, for no dust has settled in it yet. Well, now, the nuts are gone. And I don’t believe they’ll come for anything more. That frost last night will send them into winter quarters.”

The Ranger was right about the chipmunks. But he little dreamed what had driven them to it. Had Fuzzy-Wuzz not found and gobbled up the nuts they had gathered for themselves, Chuck and Chipper never would have gotten up the courage to come so often to the cabin, where Clickety-Clack, the owl, prowled about the dark corners looking for just such tid-bits as they would make for him.

As it was, Chuck and Chipper were going to have a well-stocked cache that winter.

“As an actual fact,” said the Ranger that evening, when they had told the children about it, “I don’t begrudge the little rascals what they have taken, they are such good foresters.”

“Foresters!” exclaimed the boy, dragging his father to the arm chair by the fire and snuggling against his knees, for he scented a story.

“You see,” his father told him, “they bury so many nuts that they often forget where they put them, and these nuts that are planted that way grow into trees.”

“My!” exclaimed the boy, “wouldn’t a chipmunk be surprised if he knew he planted trees!”

“He doesn’t know it. It is just a part of Mother Nature’s wonderful plan for keeping this old world going.”

The children’s mother suddenly laughed. “What do you think I saw to-day?” she asked them. “Fuzzy-Wuzz curled up asleep under a tree and looking so much like a hump of earth that a chipmunk hopped off the trunk and landed square on his nose. I don’t know which was the more surprised, the cub or the chipmunk.”

CHAPTER XVI

FUZZY-WUZZ PLAYS FATE

F UZZY-WUZZ lay basking in the late September sunshine. The mountains had blossomed forth since the frost with patches of berries that gleamed handsomely against the evergreens.

He had followed the children to a sandy place among the granite ledges back of the cabin, where they found a colony of the giant black ants. The children had been having a lot of fun with these ants. First they laid a piece of leaf over the entrance to an ant hill. Promptly one of the inmates poked his head forth to see what had so suddenly shut off the light.

Seeing the leaf, he went back and got help, and about a dozen ants came out and took hold of one edge of the leaf, and pulled, while the first ant stood on the stem and directed operations. That way, they had their entrance clear again in no time.

The next thing, the children laid a bit of bark over their front door. This time they shoved the obstruction from underneath till they had turned it over, out of their way.

Then the children laid a pebble over the hole. That was almost too much for the little colony. At first they couldn't even get out. Then they tunneled a way past the edge of the stone, and began studying the situation. Some clambered over the pebble while others walked around it, measuring. Then they tried pushing, but it was too heavy for them.

They tried pulling, but with no result. They tried getting underneath and shoving, but still they could not budge it. And at last the children got tired of waiting for them, and went away, deciding to come back later and take away the pebble if the ants had not succeeded in so doing.

Meantime Fuzzy-Wuzz had gone to sleep. His dreams were cut short by the awfulest pinching on the sensitive tip of his nose. The ants had finally

tunneled a new opening beside the pebble, though it had meant a long afternoon's work for them. Seeing the cub asleep so near, they naturally decided that he must be responsible for all their trouble, and appointed a committee to drive him away.

But because of his thick fur, they couldn't find a spot where they could reach him with their pincers except on the nose.

"Gee! I always get the worst of things!" rumbled the little brown bear, as he swept them off with one swipe of his furry paw, and would have shuffled away but for the sight that met his gaze.

Chuck, the chipmunk, stood there before him, paralyzed with fright. Coiled in front of him swayed an enormous bull snake, with red jaws open to swallow him.

If the snake had been stretched out full length, he would have been as long as the Ranger was tall. Just now he looked like a coil of thick rope, with his ugly head coming up out of the middle of the coil and pointing his forked red tongue straight at the young chipmunk.

He was a white snake, with brownish stripes that seemed to mark his back in squares. As is true of most snakes, he was not a kind that would do any harm to a child, but he swallowed chipmunks whole, and poor Chuck knew it.

It seemed to Chuck as if his legs had frozen too stiff to run away, yet if he did not run, the snake would swallow him.

At that fateful moment, Fuzzy-Wuzz caught sight of them. One pounce and the fat cub had the snake writhing between his jaws. Then the snake had wriggled away and was making for his hole, the chipmunk forgotten.

"That certainly squares the matter of the pine nuts," Chuck told his partner when he was safe back home. For the cinnamon cub had certainly played the rôle of Fate, though without realizing it. For him the snake had only meant a bit of sport.

CHAPTER XVII

BUCKY, THE BURRO

F UZZY-WUZZ had learned to ride a burro away back there when the Ranger had rescued him from drowning.

He had traveled on top of the pack as the Ranger went his rounds. After awhile he learned to leap to the little donkey's back whenever he wanted to ride. The burro never minded.

She was mighty useful to the Ranger, was the donkey, for she could carry a pack over the narrowest mountain trail. No matter how rocky and dangerous it was, she never missed her footing. (A horse sometimes slipped and fell over the canyon wall.) She also possessed the ability to go without water when it was necessary. Her compact little hoofs were just built for rocky trails, and her ancestors had lived in Egypt and the dry mountainous regions of Mexico, where a good drink every night after the day's work is over, often has to suffice. That makes a burro especially useful during the long California dry season.

Then, too, a pack burro can live, and fatten on the dry grass and leaves she can find for herself during the months when no rain falls. That is more than a horse can do. The Ranger kept a couple of saddle horses, which he had to treat with especial care, but for the long trips into the back country, or down to the settlement and back for supplies, he relied on his burros.

Jack and Bucky, as he called them, had even carried the furniture of the cabin twenty miles on their backs. And so obedient were they that one day, when the Ranger wanted to send supplies home but could not leave the settlement himself for several days yet, he simply gave the shaggy little animals a slap and pointed their noses along the home trail, and they went back all alone.

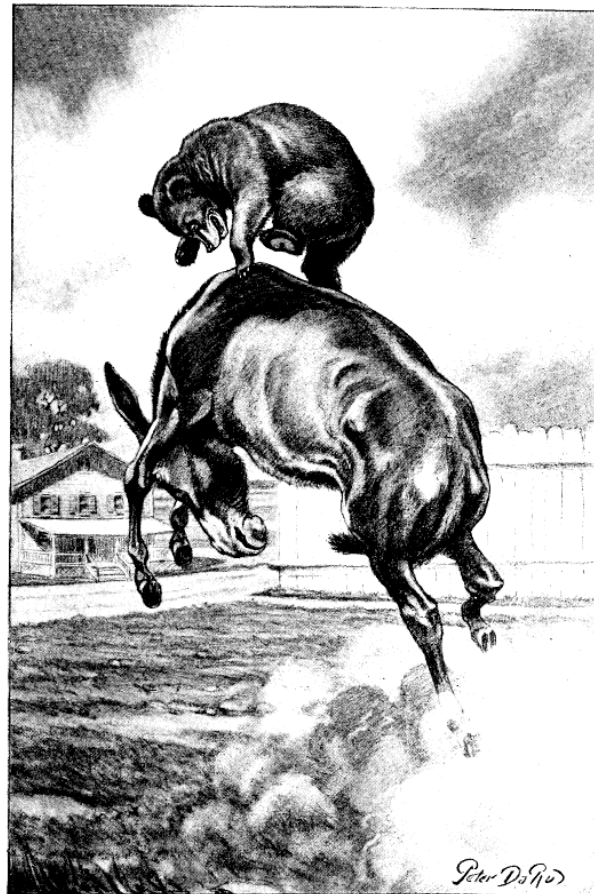
But they had one fault. They were as stubborn as could be. If they made up their minds to stop, no amount of urging, nor beating, even, could make

them change their minds. If the Ranger accidentally put too heavy a pack on their backs, or one that didn't fit comfortably, they would simply lie down, or else leap into the air with bowed backs and buck it off.

Now that spring a baby burro had been born in the corral. Young Bucky, they called the gray rascal. Such a cunning baby as he was, too, with his long, waggling ears, and almost hairless tail with just a tassel on the end of it.

At first he was so shy that every time Fuzzy-Wuzz came near, he would run for all he was worth. But gradually he got used to the fat brown cub.

The pack burros were gone on a trip to the settlement when it occurred to Fuzzy-Wuzz that he would like to take a little ride around the corral. Seeing no one but young Bucky, he leapt to his back.



The next thing Fuzzy knew, he was sailing into the air.

The next thing Fuzzy knew, he was sailing into the air, for Bucky, objecting to such a passenger, had simply given one big jump that sent the little bear flying off over his head. Nor did he stop at that. Coming with all four of his neat hoofs together, his back bowed, he leapt again and again, shaking his head angrily and grunting with the effort he had made.

After that, if Fuzzy came too near, he simply struck out at him with his hind feet, and it was only luck on Fuzzy's part that he did not get a good kick.

CHAPTER XVIII

“AS STUBBORN AS A MULE”

“**T**HERE is nothing like starting early,” said the Ranger one day, “when it comes to training animals and children. I am going to break young Bucky to the pack saddle.”

The little donkey was accordingly fitted with a pair of kyacks, almost empty to start with. So far, so good. But Bucky would not budge.

Meekly he stood there, his long ears pointed inquiringly at the Ranger and his eyes rolling till the whites showed. He made no protest, but neither could he be made to move. The Ranger did not believe in beating him. Besides, he knew from watching others that it would do no good. A burro will die under your blows, but he will not give in.

The Ranger tried coaxing, he tried commanding, he tried pulling on the halter rope and shoving from behind, but still that mite of a donkey stood with hoofs braced and refused to go one step with that pack saddle on his back.

It occurred to the Ranger that perhaps he had tried too heavy a load, for a burro knows better than any man what he can carry. He emptied the kyacks entirely. Sure enough, they had been too heavy,—light as they were. —Bucky now followed him with ears wagging peacefully, back and forth, back and forth, as is the way of burros.

He followed the Ranger, as docile as a puppy, planting his small hoofs carefully on the rocky trail. After perhaps half an hour he stopped. The Ranger coaxed him with a biscuit from his lunch, but the burro would not budge; he switched his heels, but Bucky would not move. He simply felt that it was time for a rest, and he used the one argument at his command. When he had rested long enough, he started on again of his own accord.

“He’s as stubborn as a mule,” laughed the Ranger. “But I guess he knows better than I do when he’s had enough. I wouldn’t urge him beyond his strength for anything.”

Bucky certainly had a mind of his own. Fuzzy had been frog hunting down along the creek one day when the Ranger came along on horseback, with the big burros and young Bucky following after. He was on his way to bring in firewood from a clearing where he had chopped up a fallen tree, and though Bucky was not to carry more than one stick on each side, he thought it good training for him to go along and learn to follow a pack train.

They came to a corduroy bridge across the creek. Now burros are afraid of water. Their ancestors were desert animals, and every last donkey of them has to be taught to cross a bridge. It was no different with young Bucky.

Tripping daintily along behind his mother, he stopped when he came to the first log of that bridge, and planted his fore hoofs firmly against it.

The Ranger was prepared to offer him an apple, but Bucky would only stretch his neck toward the fruit and beg without being willing to come one inch nearer for it. Then the Ranger tried to pull him by his halter rope, but he tugged and he pulled till he was afraid he would pull the rascal’s head off, without being able to budge him.

The Ranger set his wits to work once more. He had heard of people actually lighting a fire under the stubborn animals, but though the flame singed their fur, they were more afraid of the bridge.

At last, in disgust, he simply took the young burro on his back by getting under him and drawing his fore legs over his shoulders, and carried him across.

Fuzzy, watching, enjoyed it hugely.

CHAPTER XIX

THE PINTO PONY

FUZZY-WUZZ, like all bears, old or young, was fond of trout, and these autumn days it was his great delight to fish the creek.

Earlier in the year the stream had been so high that he could not have done this, but now it came no more than neck high along the banks, as he stood with barbed paw outspread, ready to spear the first fingerling that came along.

He was there fishing the day that Bucky, the young burro, got his first swimming lesson. Where the bridge crossed the creek it was deeper. It was where the children came to swim. This time Bucky protested as he had before when they came to the bridge. Then he got the surprise of his life. The Ranger simply picked the little gray beast up in his arms and flung him overboard into the pool.

You never in all your life saw such a surprised animal as young Bucky. But did he drown? Not a bit of it. Every animal—except the human—can swim if it has to, and Bucky simply struck out for shore with all fours.

Always thereafter he crossed the bridge willingly enough.

(How it did make Fuzzy's little black eyes twinkle. For he had not forgotten when Bucky bucked him off.)

Another thing interested him, too. (For there is nothing in all the woods so curious as a bear cub). That was when the Ranger taught the pinto pony to walk a log.

Away off there in the high Sierras, it is often necessary for a man's horse to make his way up and down steep slopes, over fallen tree trunks and over streams where there is no bridge. Sometimes a horse can swim, but where there is a log across a stream, those mountain-bred ponies are taught to cross the log.

First the Ranger found a log that had fallen on a bit of level ground,—a big log that would have been wide enough for two ponies to walk abreast upon. Over this he led Pinto,—as he had named the pony from the large white patches on his brown coat. That log did not seem alarming.

Next the Ranger laid a log across a shallow arm of the creek where, if Pinto had fallen off, he would not have wetted more than his ankles. That was all right, too, thought Pinto.

As the final stage in his training, the Ranger led him along a log that crossed one end of the old swimming hole, where it was really deep. But Pinto had by this time learned to trust both his master and the logs, and he crossed unafraid.

Now Fuzzy-Wuzz had followed the creek up-stream till he was so high up the mountain side that the stony creek bed was all dry except for a mere trickle, and an occasional pool. He now proceeded to explore down-stream.

Here the rocks were all hollowed out in smooth, round bowls, some of them as big as wash tubs, some only the size of finger bowls, and a few as large around as a dining-table.

When the snows melted in the spring, bringing with them a flood of rushing water and grinding stones, the stones had been swirled around and around till they had ground out these rock basins. The swimming hole was just a huge rock basin.

As Fuzzy came to deeper water, he met every here and there a make-believe waterfall. Sometimes he plunged over it head foremost, and sometimes his feet slipped out from under him before he was ready, and over the falls he went, landing in the pool beneath, and being swirled around in the rushing waters till he was half drowned.

But even a small cub is a good swimmer, and most of the time he really enjoyed the excitement.

These autumn days, however, he was to learn a new way of swimming. Now that the worst danger of forest fires was over and the Ranger had more leisure, he took two weeks off and the whole family went on a camping trip to a grove of Big Trees, and Fuzzy-Wuzz went with them.

Dapple was left to browse with the cattle, and Clickety-Clack was given the freedom of the barn; while the Ranger, his wife and boy rode horseback, and the little girl behind her father. The brown bear cub was placed on top of the pack Bucky's mother carried. Young Bucky followed after.

CHAPTER XX

THE PACK-HORSE TRIP

EVERY one enjoyed the camping trip, from the Ranger's little girl, whose first long trip it was on horseback, to Fuzzy-Wuzz, whose natural love of exploring made it a real treat to ride all day atop the burro's pack.

The sun felt good on one's fur in the crisp autumn weather, as they threaded the clean aisles of pine and fir,—and my what appetites they had! Then the starlit evenings around the bon-fire, when the little bear was allowed to snooze on the saddle blankets!

He got himself in bad one night, though, by helping himself to a plate of flapjacks before the family had had their share. If it hadn't been for that—but wait!

Bucky, the young burro, was also fond of flapjacks. In fact, he was fond of anything that could be eaten, and he was everlastingly fond of eating. The Ranger used to say there was no bottom to his stomach,—the more he put into it, the more he wanted. But then, he was growing fast.

That little gray donkey would eat anything from a thistle to a piece of paper smeared with bacon grease. As each night two or three cans of vegetables were opened, he would eat the paper off the cans for the flour paste with which they had been pasted on.

He chewed the Ranger's shoe, one night, just to sample the flavor. He loved potato parings, and raised his voice and sang for the bacon rinds.

Oh, what a voice he had! “Hee-haw, hee-haw, hee-haw!” he would bray till some one came to feed him. “It's worth while giving him something to eat, just to keep him quiet,” declared the Ranger's wife.

On the trail young Bucky, like his parents, expressed most of his feelings with his ears. When all was going well, their long ears swayed

forward and backward, forward and backward, with each step they took. If something startled them, forward would prick those great, listening ears till their curiosity had been satisfied. But if they got stubborn, back they would lay their ears as flat as they could plaster them.

One night every one was extra tired, and they all forgot and left the flour bag open. It was the night they arrived at the Big Trees, and they were too filled with awe and wonder to think of anything practical. The next morning Fuzzy happened to wake early, and went off on an exploring expedition of his own. That wonderful nose of his had told him that there was a nest of field mice somewhere about there, and he meant to dig them out.

Meantime the family arose, bathed in the river, and started breakfast preparations. While the boy brought in wood for the fire the little girl carried water from the spring, and the Ranger rounded up the stock,—as they say out West when they go to drive back the horses, who often stray in the night,—his wife made ready to bake biscuit.

She looked for the big twenty-five-pound flour sack. It was half empty, and flour was strewn all over the ground!

The two big burros were always hobbled, like the horses, over night, so that they could browse in the little mountain meadows without wandering too far. Young Bucky was left free. Just now he was nowhere in sight.

“Children,” called their mother sharply, “see what that bear of yours has done!” And Fuzzy, returning at that moment, wondered why every one scolded.

When the Ranger came in with the pack train, young Bucky’s muzzle was white with flour and his sides puffed out amazingly. “Here’s the culprit,” he sang out. “Trust a burro for raiding camp every chance he gets. Nothing but a donkey could pull through after a spree like what he’s been on.”

“Then Fuzzy didn’t do a thing,” and the boy flung his arms around the brown cub.

“Perhaps not this time, but if he hadn’t stolen those flapjacks, he wouldn’t have been misjudged.”

CHAPTER XXI

WHEN THE WORLD TURNED WHITE

IT certainly was hard, thought Fuzzy-Wuzz, for a cub bear to keep out of trouble.

Back from the camping trip, the Ranger's children spent much time in the great log barn, and Fuzzy with them. How he did love to turn somersaults in the haymow! Like a furry clown, he would tumble about as if he hadn't a bone in his body.

Sometimes the hens did not lay in their boxes, and the children used to be sent to hunt eggs, which they would find here and there in the hay. Fuzzy, too, learned to hunt for eggs, though those he found were never seen again, save for the smears of egg yolk on his jaws.

He soon found it was great sport to chase the hens and send them squawking, feathers flying as he caught a mouthful of tail plumage.

He also delighted in coming around at milking time. At first the cows were so uneasy with the little bear around that they would kick their pails over and lower their horns at him. So the Ranger tried to drive him away by milking a stream of milk at him as one would turn on the hose.

Was Fuzzy driven away? On the contrary, he just opened his mouth wide and drank it down. After that he used to come and beg to have them milk into his mouth.

But Fuzzy was finally banished from the barn. The mischievous young rascal caught a pig one day and hugged him till the pig squealed as if he were being killed. A little more and he would have been, for a bear has a powerful hug. It certainly was hard for a fun-loving little bear to keep out of trouble.

At last Fuzzy disappeared. The children searched and searched, but they could find him nowhere. They set all his favorite dainties out on the back

porch for him,—bacon, and honey, and wild gooseberries,—everything they could think of that he especially loved.

They called him, they searched the woods for some trace of his footprints in the soft ground left by the early rains, but nowhere could they find hide nor hair of him.

“Do you suppose a lion’s got him?” they worried.

“No,” laughed the Ranger. “I shouldn’t be the least bit surprised if he had gone to hibernating. You know a bear always sleeps the winter away. He can’t find anything more to eat, with the snow deep on the ground, and he can’t keep warm unless he eats, so he just creeps off into some hole and curls up into a ball, with his toes inside, and sleeps till spring.”

“Fuzzy didn’t need to. We would have fed him.”

“Yes, but you see, bears have had to hibernate for so many, many years that it has become their nature to. I guess he couldn’t help himself: he just got to feeling so sleepy that nothing else mattered.”

“But where is he hibernating? I just wish we knew where he was.”

“Oh, probably in some cave in the hillside, or under a big boulder where he would be sheltered from the wind; or perhaps he has just crawled under some fallen tree, where the snow will bank around him and make a cave, and keep the cold wind off him, and his breath will melt an air-hole.”

Then one afternoon, when the sun had been blotted out by the big white flakes of their first real, lasting snow, the boy was pitching hay from the mow for the horses when something round and furry tumbled out and into a horse stall. It was wee Fuzzy-Wuzz, who had been pried from the warm corner he had selected for his winter’s sleep.

He blinked and yawned a few times. Then he disappeared again, and it was not till the following spring that they found him snoozing away in the far corner of the haymow.

CHAPTER XXII

THE RING-TAILED CAT

THE children missed Fuzzy-Wuzz these days, the more so as Dapple, the fawn, had to spend the winter in the barn with the cows. They could not have her indoors, of course.

The Ranger found a litter of ring-tailed kittens. The kits are generally born in June, and this was October, so that they were half grown. Their mother and the two larger kittens ran away as the Ranger reached into their den in the hollow tree, but the littlest one was not quick enough.

Now the Ranger remembered his grandfather telling of the days of Forty-nine, when he joined the gold rush to California. He had had a ring-tailed cat for a pet.

Building his rude log cabin somewhere about these very mountains while he washed the precious metal out of the gravel of the creek beds, he noticed that his supplies were being pilfered, and thinking it must be a fox, he set a trap.

He was awakened in the middle of the night by the most curious sound,—half the bark a small dog makes, and half yowl. Looking to see what he had in his trap, that he could put it out of its misery, he found an animal that he at first took to be a house cat. Then he noticed that it was longer, and had a much longer tail, and shorter legs. The most curious part of it was that the tail was striped black and white, like a 'coon's. Its face, too, was pointed like that of a raccoon. Instead of the mischievous eyes peering from a black mask that a 'coon seems to have, this animal had large, gentle looking eyes and looked scared to death.

He learned later that it was a 'coon cat, or civet, more commonly called the ring-tail cat.

“There, there, pussy,” he soothed her, as he released her from the trap and carried her into his cabin. “You just come on in here and have some fish, and we’ll bury the hatchet. I need a cat to keep the field mice out of my grub,” and he straightway adopted her.

She was easy to tame. She generally slept all day and chased mice all night,—of which an abundance were attracted by his pantry shelf. She also showed her likeness to the raccoon by her fondness for fruit and sugar.

The Ranger, remembering this pet his grandfather used to tell about, decided to take the ring-tail cat home to the children. And my, how pleased they were! At first they had to keep her in a cage, or she would have run away. And when they placed food before her, she would cower to the furthest corner as if terrified.

After a couple of days of this, the Ranger told his boy that if he really meant to tame her, he would have to make her eat from his hand. After that, though she had a pan of drinking water in her cage, she got no food till she was willing to eat it out of his hand.

For several days she refused to touch what he offered her. Then the tempting odor of a piece of wild goose liver held between the boy’s fingers proved too much for her and she came up and ate it while he held it. A few days more and they could let her out of her cage.

Ring-tail, as he named her, soon became the pet of the household,—to Clickety-Clack’s disgust, for the owl liked attention too. She would play like any other kitten, and she ate all kinds of table scraps, figs and prunes being her especial fondness.

She was no end graceful, was Ring-tail, with her long, plummy tail and her pointed face. And she responded to all the old kitten tricks, from chasing her tail to wrestling with one’s hand, tooth and claw. She craved affection, too, like any house cat.

There was just one trouble. They could not trust her in the same room with the canary.

Fuzzy-Wuzz had never bothered the bird, for though he could climb, he was too clumsy to reach into the cage as it hung there above the window box. But with Ring-tail it was different.

CHAPTER XXIII

THE BABY CANARY

AWAY back last spring, before the Ranger found the little bear, the canaries had started a nest of five pretty eggs, and there the mother bird had sat, keeping them warm, while her mate sang to her.

By and by the children noticed a movement under the mother bird's wing. Then a tiny yellow head came poking out through her feathers. When she got off the next day to eat, they noticed a hole no bigger than a pin head in the shell of one of the remaining eggs, then a yellow bill was thrust through, and withdrawn again. After that there was a pecking and a struggling inside the shell, and the next thing they knew, out came the funniest baby they had ever seen, with pieces of the shell still sticking to him.

Naked he was, with eyes not yet open, and a head so large for his slender neck that he could hardly hold it up. His legs sprawled weakly from beneath him, and his toes were so fragile that it seemed as if they must break if he tried to stand on them.

The bird hatched the day before was the same. The next day came another, and the day after that, another. The fifth egg did not hatch, and the mother bird shoved it out of the nest with her foot.

My, how busy those four fledglings did keep their parents for the next two weeks! Opening their wide mouths till one could see right down their throats, they would just sit there in the nest all day long eating what their parents brought them,—chopped egg and cracker, and baby bird seed, which the big birds first cracked for them in their own bills. It seemed as if there was no getting those young canaries filled. Every time one got a mouthful, he would flap his pin-feathery wings and cry “tweet-tweet-tweet-tweet,” till one wondered how so much voice could issue from such a tiny bird.

By the time the little ones were able to stand on the roost in a row, there were only three, for one had lost his balance as he stood on the edge of the nest, and all the flapping of his nearly naked wings had not served to break his fall.

Chirping their high-pitched food call, the remaining birdlings would flap wings that just began to show a row of teeny, pale yellow feathers along the edges.

Then a dreadful thing happened. A great brown butcher bird lived in a thorn bush not far away. This horrid creature lived on mice and little birds, and like the witch of the fairy tale, hung his victims on the thorns till he was ready to eat them.

One day the children thought the canaries would like to be out of doors, and hung the cage in a pine tree. An hour later that butcher bird had reached in through the bars of the cage and bitten the heads off the whole canary family save one little one. He had been in the nest out of reach.

The little girl cried her heart out. But they decided they would do their best to bring that fledgling up by hand. By this time he was just about big enough to have gone to bed in a teaspoon. His wings were fringed with pale yellow, and he would perch on a fore finger and open his mouth for them to feed him, chirping shrilly and flapping his wings with all his might to keep from falling off.

The boy gave him just the tiniest bits at a time on the end of a flattened twig. Soon he was able to eat for himself. At night he had to be snuggled into a warm nest made of an old piece of flannel, and every day his cage was set in the sunshine and he was given a saucer of clean, warm water to bathe in. My, how he did love to splash.

The children wondered if he were going to be a singer, like his father. He was three months old before he really tried very hard to show them. Then what a golden voice had that golden yellow bird! At first he had been pale yellow, but the larger he grew, the yellower became his plumage. They named him Caruso.

Sometimes the children would let him out of his cage in the living room. How he loved the freedom of it! How he explored the plants in the

south window, and the silver spoons on the table! He loved everything bright and shiny.

As he had never known what fear was (except the time the butcher bird came), he would ride about on the children's shoulders and eat out of their hands.

They taught him to come when they called him, and it was a common sight to see the children doing their lessons around the lamp of an evening and Caruso perching on their fingers or picking at their pencil points.

Any sudden movement startled him, but until the other pets came, a more trustful little bird you never saw. That is why, unless Ring-tail and Fuzzy-Wuzz and Clickety-Clack were shut out of the room, he had always had to stay in his cage.

CHAPTER XXIV

“JEST AN ORNERY PUP”

SOMETIMES the Ranger took the children snow-shoeing through the winter woods. Their game was to find and name as many footprints as they could, of the many they saw criss-crossing the snow. Sometimes they could read a story in those footprints, like the time they followed the delicate mouse tracks till those of a fox told the end of the story.

They soon learned to know the difference between the pointed tracks of the deer and the manlike footprints of the mice and squirrels, raccoons and bears. Then there were the doglike prints of the foxes and coyotes, and the catlike marks of the wild cats,—those handsome gray striped Bay lynxes that looked so much like big house cats except for their tasseled ears and big feet, bobbed tails and the fur that hung down from their cheeks in points. Once they caught a glimpse of one crouched on the limb of a tree,—a beauty of a great, fierce cat with his round yellow eyes.

Once they even came across the giant catlike track of a mountain lion, and their father made them go back while he followed with his gun.

He could tell whether an animal had been walking or running, whether it had been chasing something or was being chased, or whether it was a deer or a doe. It made these winter walks mighty interesting to the children.

Just before Christmas the Ranger went to the settlement on his snow-shoes to get the mail. When he came back, out of his coat pocket tumbled a yellow ball of fur.

“A dog!” his wife exclaimed.

“‘Jest an ornery pup,’ the grocer says. But I figured he might come in handy with our small fry,” by which he meant the children. “They’re missing that cub so mightily.”

“I don’t believe anything will ever crowd Fuzzy-Wuzz out of their affections,” she smiled back.

“Well, I’ll feel safer about them, anyhow, if we have a dog about the place.”

The children welcomed him ardently. He was a friendly, wriggling fellow, was Wiggledy,—as they promptly named him. Just a yellow puppy, part terrier and part something else, the Ranger thought him. But a love-hungry heart beat in that furry chest. He was soon pals with both children.

Young animals can generally be trained to eat out of the same dish. But Ring-tail was a half grown cat when Wiggledy arrived, and it was too late, so far as she was concerned, to make friends between them.

Wiggledy soon came to look upon everything the children owned as under his especial guardianship. One day when he and Ring-tail had been shut in the barn while the children had their lessons, he barked so hard that their mother sent them to see what the trouble was.

They opened the barn door and called him, but he would not come. Instead, he kept running to the rain water barrel in the far corner of the vacant horse stall, and back again. “Hush your noise!” scolded the little girl. But he only set his teeth in her skirt and tried to pull her after him. At last she came with him.

Dragging her to the water barrel, he stood on his hind legs, and with fore paws against the barrel, began barking harder than ever.

She peered within. It was dusk in that corner of the barn, and at first she could see nothing. At last her eyes made out a movement in the water. Peering closer, she saw, just above the water line, which was half way down the barrel, the pointed face of the ring-tail cat. Ring-tail often drank from the barrel, reaching down while she clung with hind feet on the barrel rim. This time she had lost her balance and fallen in. She was swimming feebly. A moment more and she suddenly sank out of sight.

At his sister’s cry, the boy came running, and fished out the drowning animal. Ring-tail’s eyes were shut and her body felt stiff and cold.

Tearfully they carried her into the cabin, where their mother gave her a swallow of something hot and laid her behind the kitchen stove in a warm

blanket. Anxiously the yellow pup watched and waited, every now and then giving her wet face a lick, and whimpering inquiringly.

When at last she began to move her claws feebly and to open her eyes a crack, my! how joyously he barked.

“I vow that pup deserves a medal for life-saving,” declared the Ranger, giving Wiggledy a ham bone.

But at that moment Ring-tail, having fully revived, snatched his bone away.—She was certainly feeling better.

CHAPTER XXV

A REGULAR DOG

WIGGLEDY loved nothing better than to go snow-shoeing with the Ranger's children.

Of course the fat pup was helpless in the deep snow, but he would go plunging into their snow-shoe tracks, leaping from one to another with the most joyous barking and wriggling and flapping of ears.

Sometimes he caught up with them. Then he would try to steal a ride on the back of a snow-shoe, till they discovered why it was so hard to lift that foot.

After awhile they taught him to help them bring in the firewood. Giving him just one small stick at a time to take between his jaws, they had him trotting ahead of them, every trip they made.

Later they made him a harness and taught him to drag their light sled over the snow crust, though he would have to grow a lot before he could bring in wood that way. To both the children and the pup it was all just fun. They wouldn't have enjoyed it a bit if they had had to do it.

"I do believe that pup's going to pan out a regular dog," the Ranger decided. "I tell you what, it takes these mongrels for just plain, ordinary brains,—not the kind that bird dogs have, nor fighting dogs, nor any special kind, but just plain all-'round brains."

"And heart," added his wife softly, watching the children romping with Wiggledy on the hearth rug. "I'll feel now, if anything happened to the children when they're out snow-shoeing, he'll come and tell me, or die fighting for them."

"I hadn't noticed that he was particularly scrappy."

“Ho, ho! You haven’t seen him chasing Clickety-Clack. I wonder how he’ll hit it off with the little bear.”

“That we shall see when spring comes.”

Now Ring-tail had formed the habit of sleeping on the children’s bed. When Wiggledy first came, he was so tiny and so lonesome that he, too, was taken under cover. About this time the excitement began.

When the two animals were kept on opposite sides of the bed, there was peace. But let Wiggledy come too near and Ring-tail promptly boxed his ears. Then he would yelp and scuttle closer to the children. And sometimes they were awakened by a regular cat and dog fight,—in which the pup, being the youngest, generally got the worst of it.

If the pup were banished, he howled forlornly till they took him back to the warmth of their beds and hearts. Finally it came to be understood between them that Wiggledy was to sleep down at the foot, under a fold of blanket, while Ring-tail took the head, where the feather-bed billowed out above the children’s heads, and where she could come and go without disturbing any one,—for she was still a prowler of the night.

If the children overslept and Wiggledy got hungry, he would simply pull the covers off them.

The question was what would happen when Fuzzy-Wuzz came back.

CHAPTER XXVI

CHUMS

IT was still damp on the forest floor, with here and there a patch of melting snow, when Fuzzy-Wuzz awoke from his winter sleep in the haymow.

But down on the rocks where the lake lapped over pebbly levels, the sun shone hot and still. Here the little bear was basking when the yellow pup first sighted him.

“How-wow?” exclaimed Wiggledy, the force of his bark raising him clear off his feet.

“Hoof?” asked the cub, rising on his fat hind legs inquiringly.

The children, who had been watching, arrived at that moment, and explained to the pair that they must be friends, though this would hardly have been necessary. The two young animals were soon romping delightedly together. Inside a week they were chums.

Lizards basked on the warm rocks, and the new-made comrades, tired of wrestling and playing tag, sprawled out side by side one day to watch them. By and by they began to notice that the rocks and sandy shallows all around them were alert with little goggle eyes that peered up at them with an unwinking stare.

The eyes were set in round bodies mottled brown and deeper brown, just the size of bantam’s eggs with long, fish-like tails attached. What could they be, asked Wiggledy with a soft rumble in his throat.—Fuzz, being near-sighted, did not see them till they moved. The eyes were set in heavy, protruding lids.

They were bull-frog babies, and the two watchers crept down over their boulder, Fuzzy-Wuzz with paw outstretched ready to make a grab at them. The fat tad-poles would wait saucily till his claws were just above them,

then with a sudden flirt of their fleshy tails, they would flip away, just barely out of reach. Then they would turn and ogle the little bear with their bulging eyes again. It was tantalizing.

Sometimes Fuzzy would feel a soft body slip past his paw, but before he could clutch it, the prize would be far away, and circling teasingly back again.

Finding a precarious footing on the tip of a rock just above one of the thickest colonies, Fuzzy made a sudden grab,—but quick as thought, they had slapped their way in a solid body just far enough to be out of reach,—and there they ogled him again, maliciously.

The fat cub now moved to another rock to try the trick. This time, splash! he slipped into the slimy water. My, how disgusted he was at that!

With one swift bat of his good right paw, he flipped through the water. This time he sent one flying out on shore. Clambering out himself, he examined his prize drippingly.

Soft and round as an egg without a shell, the tad-pole displayed the buds of feet, where later would sprout as plump a pair of frog's legs as ever graced a frying pan. His brown back Mother Nature had tinted to look like the rocks to any creature hunting from above.

With cautious paw, the cub flopped him over on his back, displaying the shining nether side that would look so like water to any fish foe hunting from below him.

The pink gills were wide open and gasping, for he was drowning as surely on land as a cub would have drowned under water. With a snap of his jaws, Fuzzy finished the life story of that young frog-to-be.

The chums spent much of their time, the next few weeks, hunting bull-frog tad-poles and field mice together.

CHAPTER XXVII

PRETTY PAWS, THE PINE SQUIRREL

ONE hot day Fuzzy-Wuzz had gone to sleep in a pine tree when he was awakened by a little high-pitched bark, like the yap of a young fox.

He opened one eye cautiously. There on a limb higher up stood a squirrel, scolding him for all she was worth. But she was not like the gray squirrels he had seen. She was dark brown, and her under side, and all four paws were a rich orange color. Her tail was bordered with yellow.

It was Pretty Paws, the pine squirrel. She was a member of the Douglas squirrel tribe, (named after the man who discovered them). She must have considered the little bear an intruder, the way she scolded. Was this her particular pine tree, he wondered?

His little black eyes twinkling, he climbed a little higher,—though he was pretty near the top for even his small weight. At that she scolded more angrily than ever, fairly rising into the air with the ferocity of her barking. She was joined by her mate, who also barked at Fuzzy.

“Ha, ha!” thought the little bear, “there must be a reason for all this noise they are making. I must find out what it is.” And he wondered if such small creatures could really hurt a bear cub, as they were surely threatening to do.

The wind, which had been blowing through the tree top, came to a rest, and with that, Fuzzy caught a delightful odor. It was the odor of mushrooms. Where could they be, away up here in the tree top, he asked himself? He meant to find out, for of all the plants that grew in those woods, he loved mushrooms best. He climbed a few steps higher. The squirrels leapt to a branch below. They were now facing him, and threatening to eat him alive.

He made a sudden rush at them, with a deep throated “Woof!” They backed away. At that, his eyes twinkled more than ever. They were only bluffing.

He climbed to the next limb,—the tree top swaying with his weight. There, spread out along the limb in the sunshine, drying, he saw what had smelled so wonderful,—a whole row of mushrooms. But how could they have gotten away up there? For they were mushrooms that he had found on the ground. He gobbled them greedily.

He thought he understood now why the squirrels had scolded so. These were the mushrooms they had collected, and laid out to dry for winter use. But they had been his mushrooms, he told himself, when they grew on the ground beneath the tree. Never mind, he would make them his again.

The children, attracted by the barking in the tree top, called their father to tell them what it was. These pine squirrels, he explained, were cousins to the red squirrels of the East.

Just now Pretty Paws and her mate were calling loudly for all their friends and relatives to come and help them scare the cub away. But Fuzzy munched right on, enjoying each mushroom in turn.

Almost instantly the woods resounded with the call notes of neighboring pine squirrels, who were coming to see what the trouble was all about,—for squirrels are mighty curious about all that is going on about them. Some of them helped scold Fuzzy, others sang and trilled almost like birds.

The first litters of young were out that afternoon, and some of these orange-breasted sprites became so excited that they simply rushed up and down their tree trunks, playing tag in joyous excitement.

“I’ll catch you, if you don’t shut up!” Fuzzy woofed at them as he finished his feast and descended awkwardly, tail end first, till he could drop from a lower branch like a fat little bag of flour.

But though he spent all that afternoon, and many another, chasing Pretty Paws and her friends, as they came down to gather pine seeds and insect larvæ, he never once succeeded in getting so much as a mouthful of fur. Before he could grab them, they were safe on a limb, flirting their tails saucily at him and calling him all sorts of names.

Later he saw Pretty Paws racing through the tree tops with a great brown creature in hot pursuit. It was a pine marten, or sable,—a rare animal for even those mountains. Fuzzy didn't believe the squirrel had a chance in the world.

He watched while Pretty Paws went leaping from branch to branch, and from tree to tree, and the marten after her. As agile as herself, for all his great size, was that marten. How it ended Fuzzy never knew, for he could not follow fast enough. But if it wasn't Pretty Paws herself who barked at him next day, it was her twin sister.

CHAPTER XXVIII

THE RATTLESNAKE DEN

FUZZY often wandered far down the mountain side.

One hot week in July his restless wandering carried him almost down to the valley. He had been chasing a jack rabbit through the tall grass when he was startled by a sound like the rustling of a dry leaf, only ever so many times louder. He jumped out of the way till he could find out what it would be that could make such a queer sound.

As he did so, a great snake shot from its coil to the spot where he had been but an instant before. Its mouth was open and it displayed two long, sharp fangs. Its scaly back was mottled with cross-wise stripes, dark, reddish brown, with yellow edges to the lighter spots.

Fuzzy's fur rose along the back of his neck. He had caught many a snake and eaten it with relish, but not this kind. This one was different. This must be what had made that ominous rattling sound. He had nearly stepped on it.

He started to climb between two boulders and go on his way, but no sooner had he set foot on the spot than there came another of those peculiar rattling sounds, then another, and another. He had stepped into a den of rattlesnakes.

Now the rattler always plays fair. It gives warning before it strikes. As an actual fact, it will not strike at all unless some one comes near stepping on it or makes it fear for its life. But the unfortunate Fuzzy-Wuzz had actually stepped into the retreat of a whole colony of baby snakes. And the babies themselves were equipped with poison fangs. There must have been other mothers there, too, the way they rattled. And now the first snake was all coiled ready to spring again, her ugly flat head rising straight up out of the middle of the coil and her tail again rattling its buttons warningly.

The little bear leapt for his life, but he was not quite quick enough. One of the snakes, (he never knew which one,) struck his left hind foot a terrific blow, driving its fangs in till it had squeezed the little poison bag that lies at the root of each fang, so that the poison ran down a groove in the fang.

Fuzzy ran till he was safely away from that dangerous neighborhood, then he began to feel the effects of the poison. His foot swelled, and he felt as if he could lie right down and die.

A great many animals would have died. A man who has been struck by a rattler can only be saved by drawing all the poison out of the wound, and other mighty serious treatment.

It was a mighty serious matter with the little bear. But bears are hardy specimens. They can survive a great many things that other animals cannot. He was pretty ill for a time, but three weeks later he came limping back to the Ranger's cabin.

My, how glad the children were to see him! How they hugged and feasted him! He liked it, too. He had been through a lot since last he went exploring.

Wiggledy was just as glad to greet his chum. Every one was glad except Clickety-Clack, the little screech owl, whom he was soon chasing as merrily as ever, and Dapple, the yearling fawn, who had never had much to do with him. After that for several days the pup and the bear dug quietly for ground squirrels.

These ground squirrels were skimpy tailed and stupid, and lived in holes that they dug for themselves and their large litters of young along the edges of the mountain meadows. Several families of them had home-steaded in one corner of the Ranger's garden patch, where they ate things as fast as they grew. The Ranger was mighty glad when he saw Fuzzy after them.

The chums would each select a hole and see which could dig out a squirrel the quickest, dog or bear. But Fuzzy always won, for his long claws were much better digging implements than the pup's.

There were mice, too, to be found under the fallen logs farther back in the woods. These mice of the high Sierras were red-backed fellows whose coats so matched the reddish soil that they were hard to see, even when they sat right out in plain sight. Fuzzy depended more on his nose than his eyes

when he followed their run-ways around the stumps and rocks that hid their homes.

Sometimes he would find a whole mossy nestful of them in some hollow stump or under a rock. Then the young mice, if they were old enough to run, would race in all directions, and Fuzzy-Wuzz could only turn around and around, wondering which one to chase first, while Wiggledy barked and hopped about in wild excitement.

CHAPTER XXIX

MOTHER BROWN BEAR AND THE BULL

FUZZY-WUZZ had grown by now to be as fine a yearling brown bear as you will find in the Sierras.

The quaking aspens along the creek were beginning to turn scarlet when he yielded to a restless feeling that often came, and started on a journey that took him back over the way the Ranger had come the year before, when Fuzzy rode on top of the burro's pack.

When at last he came to the rapids where he had so nearly drowned, something about the place seemed familiar. As if repeating a lesson he had learned when he was very, very young, he turned and walked up the glacier-smoothed granite slope to where a giant boulder blocked the mouth of the den. He sniffed. It was the cave in which he had been born.

It was empty now, but from the odor of warm fur he judged that it had not been empty more than a few minutes. With his nose to the ground, he started following up the trail they had left,—a trail pungent of warm fur to his understanding nose.

It led straight to a patch of wild gooseberry bushes, and from there to a flower-dotted mountain meadow where range cattle browsed. Fuzzy hesitated. He never saw a range cow now but he looked for the nearest tree. There was no tree anywhere near.

Just as he was about to turn back, he caught a glimpse of a huge furry form that he knew to be his mother.

Cautiously he approached. Would she be glad to see him, after so long, or had she given him up for drowned, and would she chase him away as she would a strange cub?

He came a little nearer,—then he stared. Waddling along flat-footedly behind her were two wee cubs, brown balls of fur as tiny as he had been

when the Ranger found him.

He whimpered joyously. Just then a range bull turned, caught sight of the wee cubs, and doubtless taking them for dogs, charged them with lowered horns.

Mother Brown Bear rose to her great hind feet with a growl. Then seeing that the bull still came on, she bounded to a point midway between him and her babies, and waited. The next instant he was opposite her.

With one twist of his ugly horns he could have torn her half in two, but she never hesitated, not where the safety of her babies was concerned. She would have died fighting for those helpless mites if need be.

With one sweep of her great, steel-strong fore arm she delivered a blow on the back of his neck. It felled him flat, for his spine was broken. Such is the strength of a full grown brown bear. Lucky he is a good natured animal when no one molests him.

Calling gently to her cubs to follow, she now hastened back to the den. Fuzzy stepped into view as she neared him, whining an eager greeting. But she only growled out a warning not to come near her babies. Fuzzy thought best to obey. Slowly he wandered back to the river, then on home to the Ranger's cabin.

It had certainly been pretty fine to have his freedom, but he was always mighty glad to come back to the children and the good things they always feasted him with.

For awhile he was content to play around with the pup. One day, towards sun-down, the children heard an unusual commotion in the woods. Wiggledy was barking madly, while Fuzzy-Wuzz stood on his hind legs sniffing at something that hung from a limb.

At first it looked like a great leaf. Then the children saw that the leaf had a mouselike body covered with red-brown fur, and the face of a big-eared gnome. It was a bat, with great, leathery wings. She hung by the edge of one wing, on a hooked-nail that would have been her thumb nail, had it been her arm and outstretched fingers that formed the ribs of her wing.

There she hung, in the full glow of the setting sun. But the oddest thing about her was this.—Clinging to her were three baby bats, wee things that

she was nursing as they clung to her teats.

Presently she saw a moth and flew after it, snapping her teeth in it hungrily after a short chase. And when she flew, she carried the babies clinging to her, just as they had been before. (For she had no place to leave them in safety.)

She hung herself up on another tree, and once more began watching for her prey. The children tried to catch her, for a closer look at so strange a creature, and finally succeeded in cornering her in an angle of the barn. The boy,—who knew how to handle animals,—grabbed her by the scruff of the neck where she could not reach out to bite him.

My, how furiously she squeaked! How she ground her teeth and struggled to turn her head and get a nip at him! But he held her tight, careful neither to hurt the valiant little mother nor to get hurt himself, while they examined her funny, big-eared, almost human face. Then they let her go, and she disappeared into the dusk.

Fuzzy was disgusted to think they had not given her to him.

CHAPTER XXX

PIKA OF THE PEAKS

ALL that summer Fuzzy wandered, wandered everywhere in search of adventure. There was hardly a spot within miles of the Ranger's cabin that he had not explored. For he was looking for a range that he could call his own. Sometimes he found an inviting bit of country, but some other bear had already made his home on it.

One mellow day that autumn he climbed to the very tree line. Coming out on a wind-swept height where the only trees were the twisted junipers whose branches clung to the ledge, he was just about to drink at a trickle of water that welled out of a crack in the rocks when he heard the queerest sound.

It sounded like a giant cricket, "cheep, cheep, cheep," high-pitched and plaintive. He looked about to see where it came from, for a cricket would make fine eating.

First the sound seemed to come from behind him, then from the side; then it sounded for all the world as if it must be in the rocks around on the other side. Fuzzy was mystified.

Like a gray shadow, something glided to the top of a stone not far away. It looked like a small rabbit, except that it had big, round ears rimmed with white. It was a pika.

The little bear had never seen a pika. He knew nothing of its ways. That is why he made a dash for this one. Had he known, he might have saved himself a lot of trouble. For no sooner had he moved than the little creature had disappeared from the stone. What had become of it he could not imagine.

Again came that long-drawn cricket sound, echoing from somewhere underneath the rocks. Madly he started digging into the slide-rock, near

where the bunny-like creature had disappeared. He might as well have tried to dig a hole through the mountain for all the results he got. The pika was not there.

Pausing to get his breath and cool off, he suddenly espied, sitting calmly watching him, the same gray shadow on the same gray stone.

This time he made an even swifter dash, but again the pika was not there. When Fuzzy became quite worn out, and had curled up in a furry ball to take a nap, the little dweller of the mountain peaks went calmly to work getting in his winter food supply.

Nibbling through the stems of as many flowers and grasses as he could carry in his mouth, he would lay the little bundle neatly on a rock in the sunshine and spread it out to dry. After awhile, when the sun no longer shone on those rocks, he carried his hay to one where it did.

That way, he worked steadily on, all alone on the mountain top. Soon, he knew, would come the biting cold and the banking snow, and he would need enough hay to keep him fat and warm in his den in the rocks.

Once a hawk spied him out as he worked, and made a swoop for him. Yesterday it had been a lion, the day before coyotes. But Pika only slipped in between two rocks where nothing could get at him, and waited till the danger was gone.

When at last the sun grew cool and the little bear awoke, and stretched, Pika was sitting watching him like a gray shadow on a gray rock, but so still he sat, and so silently, that Fuzzy-Wuzz never even dreamed how near he was, but went shambling off down the mountain side in the gathering dusk, while Pika once more sang his cricket song.

CHAPTER XXXI

FUZZY AND THE WEASEL

OF all the curious furry folk that Fuzzy saw that summer, the weasel was the most curious looking little beast.

At first glimpse he thought it was a black snake that went gliding through the scarlet fire-weed. The long, humped body with its flat, almost earless head and long neck ended in a tail nearly as long. Behind the pointed nose, the blood-thirsty villain's red eyes glowed cruelly.

The weasel was after a mouse, when the little bear first saw him, and so slim was he that he could follow that unhappy victim straight down into his hole. He emerged in two minutes licking his bloody jaws, for he had not eaten the whole mouse, but only quenched his thirst, as is the way with weasels.

Chuck and Chipper, and indeed the whole chipmunk horde, had hidden in their furthest dens at first glimpse of the blood-sucker. Nor was that all: each was prepared to flee for his life through his emergency exit, should the killer start down their front entryway.

The clumsy-looking ground squirrels developed a speed of which Fuzzy had not supposed them capable, as the dark, snaky form went twisting and turning through the under-growth with his nose to the patch-work of their trails. One old fellow took refuge in a stone pile, but the weasel squirmed his way after him, through every chink and crevice, till Fuzzy heard his victim utter his last unhappy squeal.

But did that stop the killer? Merely tasting the warm blood, the weasel left his catch uneaten and started after another. Now most of the wild folk who kill at all, kill because they must eat. But the weasel is different: he kills for the love of killing. He is the villain of the play. No mouse or chipmunk whose trail he starts to follow ever gets away from him.

Now there was a big rabbit that Fuzzy had chased off and on all summer, but always the little animal flapped its ears saucily and got away. It was not afraid of Fuzzy, and could easily outrun him. The rabbit had been eating every green thing that came up in the Ranger's garden, and Fuzzy had felt it his duty to rid the place of the fellow. Besides, though mostly a vegetarian, he had often thought that rabbit would be good eating.

To-day the rabbit was just settling down to demolish a head of the Ranger's lettuce when the weasel, running along with his nose to the ground, crossed its trail. Sniffing eagerly at the scent of warm fur, he raced up to the flap-eared one.

Now a rabbit has perfectly good hind legs. If its courage had been as good, no weasel could have overtaken it in a race. At first this particular rabbit, sniffing the air for signs of an enemy, thought it was only the little bear, and went right on eating, wagging its ears saucily.

Then it saw the weasel. With one great bound it was leaping away through the woods, the little weasel after it, but losing ground.

Then the foolish rabbit leapt high to see where its enemy was. The weasel was sneaking along in such a snake-like manner that at first it couldn't see him, so the foolish bunny circled back to make sure.

Now the weasel was just on the point of giving up, seeing that here was one victim he could not hope to overtake, when the rabbit suddenly came back, saw him still pursuing, and losing heart, squatted down, paralyzed with fear, uttering a squeal for mercy.

Instantly the weasel was on the rabbit's back, biting the cowardly beggar back of the ear, where it killed it instantly. But a taste of the hot blood and the weasel was satisfied, and ran away to chase barn rats.

"Am I in luck?" Fuzzy asked himself, licking his jaws hungrily.

The Ranger also thought himself in luck, for inside a week the weasel had rid the barn of rats, and betaken himself away to new hunting grounds.

CHAPTER XXXII

WAPITI

THE little bear felt more and more strongly the call to go exploring. So many things interested him, and he was so apt to find something new and delicious to eat. Besides, he felt it would soon be time to hibernate again, and now that he was getting so large, he wanted a home of his own,—some rocky den where he could be entirely by himself when he felt like it.

During the spring and summer the mule deer, (Dapple's tribe,) had been the largest he had seen. But now that the larches had turned old gold, he sometimes met a herd of wapiti, or American elk, who had summered high in the mountains, in the stunted forests of timber line where they could browse on the foliage of the very tree tops and the lush grass of the high alpine meadows.

At the approach of winter they came down to seek the shelter of the valleys.

Every herd had its patriarch, a huge old bull wapiti, whose wide branching antlers would suddenly appear on the sky-line while he scanned the slopes. Then he would give the signal to the herd of cow wapiti and their calves who were under his protection, to follow to the feeding-grounds he had selected.

Fuzzy was afraid to come too near, for he had disliked horns and antlers ever since his experience with the range cow the year before. But his curiosity often drew him to watch these strange creatures from the safe shelter of some clump of brush.

After the first snow-fall, the wapiti would paw the ground bare with their fore hoofs till they could get at the mosses underneath. At this time the herd was joined by several others, and at night they always slept in a circle, the bulls on the outside, the cows next, and their calves in the very middle.

Fuzzy wondered and wondered why they did it, till one night, when he had elected to sleep away from home.

It was starlight in the open spaces, shadowy under the trees, when he was awakened by a peculiar shiver that ran along his spine and made the fur on the back of his neck prickle. This, he knew, meant danger, though at first he could not see what it was that menaced him. Then, suddenly, he noticed a slinking, almost soundless movement along the limb of a tree between him and the wapiti on the creek bank.

Slowly, slowly the giant cat, a mere moving shadow in his tawny coat against the shadows that didn't move, leapt to the ground and began edging, inch by inch, toward the sleeping herd. But was it sleeping? Fuzzy thought he saw the gleam of several pairs of eyes against their moveless bulk.

The cat was edging around them watching for some point where he might approach them from behind. But on every side he was faced by a barricade of pronged antlers that could have pierced him through. Finally as he came too near, the bulls arose and stood waiting—just waiting for him to come closer. But at that the lion turned and leapt into a tree, and though Fuzzy watched till he could no longer keep his eyes open, he saw no movement in that tree, nor was the lion in the tree when morning came. Nor was the herd reduced by the loss of so much as one calf.

CHAPTER XXXIII

DAPPLE DISAPPEARS

AS her second summer came to an end, Dapple was seen to be more and more vain. Every day she licked her fur till it shone. She had even made friends with a young cow of almost equal vanity, who did her the service of washing her neck where she could not reach it, a service she returned in kind.

Then one day she disappeared. The children were mystified, but Fuzzy could have told them what had become of her.

His wanderings had often taken him into the haunts of the mule deer. Not that he ever got very near them. Even had he trusted the antlers of the bucks he saw summering together in the high country,—they had prongs even before the tall branching antlers came in September,—he could not have escaped observation, so keen were both their eyes and their ears.

Then in the wooded valleys he had watched the blacktail does with their dappled fawns.

Seeing in the little fellows something so like what Dapple had been the year before, he sometimes tried to play tag with them, but no sooner would he make a movement toward them than off they would bound in great leaps that took them clear over the tops of the bushes, and in two seconds they were clear out of sight, doe and fawns together.

Not even when they slept could he surprise them, for they slept with all four feet under them, and at the slightest sound, crack would go the brush about them, as they rose into the air, then off they would bounce, like so many rubber balls, thud, thud, thud!

It became a game that Fuzzy played with himself, to try to catch them unawares, but let him approach never so softly, with the wind blowing his

scent in entirely the other direction, their big ears were sure to hear him, though they had been sound asleep.

Yes, sir, Fuzzy could have told the children what had become of Dapple. But he didn't, and they mourned her as lost, finally deciding that she must have fallen victim to a mountain lion.

He had seen the bucks come down from the high country as autumn crisped the air, their double branched antlers gleaming proudly. He had watched them battling on the lake shore o' moonlight nights, their antlers clashing angrily at one another, while the does—and Dapple—watched them from safe covert.

And before ever he began his winter's sleep he had seen them gather into herds, does and bucks together,—and Dapple with them,—as many as he had toes and fingers put together, in a sheltered canyon where they could winter.

CHAPTER XXXIV

DAPPLE'S SECRET

AS winter approached, and Fuzzy wandered farther and farther afield, the bullfrogs wriggled deep into the mud to sleep the white months away, the trout he had so often caught sought the deepest water they could find, in the very bottom of the ice-covered lake, the birds flew further south, the chipmunks retired to the depths of their well-stocked burrows, the pine squirrels took to their hollow trees except when the sun shone warmest, and the mice crept so deep into the frozen ground that Fuzzy could not dig them out.

The children still had the owl and the canary, and one day they discovered Ring-tail in the haymow with three kittens, but Wiggledy, now a well-grown pup, was their chief comrade, for Fuzzy-Wuzz had also disappeared.

He had not chosen the haymow this time in which to sleep the winter away, for he had found the most delightful den in the rocks,—a regular cave, which he had lined with armfuls of dry pine needles, till it was as snug and warm as anything he could desire. Moreover, he could hide away in it and no one could disturb him.

Spring came, setting the streams to frothing over their boulder-strewn beds. The banks of the quieter pools echoed to the song of the re-awakened bullfrogs. Chipmunks chattered through the tree tops, birds returned, filling the air with their love songs, and mice scuttled through the new green grass. But no Fuzzy came scratching at the cabin door, and no Dapple came to the children's call.

Then one early morning the boy, now a well-grown lad of twelve, was out milking the cows when a pale, tawny form in the edge of the woodland attracted his eye. It was a doe, and he held his breath for a good look at her. She did not move. For long minutes he stared at the mild-eyed creature,

fearing if he moved, she would go bounding away. Then—could his eyes deceive him?—she came prancing straight toward him.

“Dapple!” he called joyously. “Dapple! Can it really be you?” And at the sound of his voice, she came to his outstretched hand and licked it.

Then a sharp sound of snapping twigs in the underbrush behind her sent her bounding back. The boy stared after her. There, frightened to death at their close approach to human kind, and ready to leap away at the slightest danger, stood two tiny spotted fawns, as like what Dapple herself had been as anything that could be imagined.

A moment more they stood hesitant, then as the boy took one step nearer, Dapple went bouncing back into the thick woods, the fawns following.

CHAPTER XXXV

OLD FRIENDS

THE children had climbed high that day with their berry pails.

Wiggledy had gone bounding on ahead, threatening every squirrel and chipmunk with the most ferocious barks. Suddenly he began sniffing at the ground in a way that attracted the children's curiosity, then went bounding off with joyful yelps.

"What can it be?" wondered the little girl. "He never ran away and left us like that before."

"Let's go along and find out," proposed the boy.

They had to run to keep the dog in sight. Sometimes he would stop and peer into the branches of a tree, then sniff about underneath. Then off he would race again, nose to the ground, uttering happy yelps and whimpers.

The way he led them zig-zagged this way and that, but always it took them higher. At last they found themselves away up on the mountain side almost to timber line. Then Wiggledy disappeared in a berry patch too thorny for them to follow.

As they stood waiting and calling for him to come back, and filling their pails from the berries within reach, the little girl began staring at the rocks further up. When the boy glimpsed her frightened eyes he, too, stared in the direction she was gazing.

From behind a mammoth boulder peered a huge brown head, with a long yellowish snout.

Slowly a huge, furry form came lumbering forth, walking awkwardly flat-footed, wagging its head from side to side. It was headed straight toward them.

Now it arose to its full height, sniffing the breeze and peering apparently right at them with its near-sighted little eyes. Then down on all fours again went the shaggy beast. It was a brown bear,—the largest they had ever seen.

The children didn't know which way to turn. Of course they knew, as their father had often told them, that a brown bear will not harm human kind, unless wounded or cornered or trying to defend its young. But how could they be sure this bear had not been wounded, or had no cubs somewhere hidden among the rocks and thought they were after them!

The little girl was in for running, but the boy sternly bade her stay still and show no fear. Wiggledy was still racing around in the berry patch with his nose to the ground. Just then the wind veered. With a frantic yelp the dog went flying straight toward the bear.

“Wiggledy! Come back!” called the boy, frightened lest the bear would kill him. But the dog raced on.

Then something happened that left them speechless with amazement. The little dog and the big bear began romping together just as had the pup and the yearling cub the year before.

“It IS Fuzzy-Wuzz!” cried the boy. “Come here, you old rascal you,” and he fished a hunk of gingerbread from his pocket and strode up to the bear.

The bear shambled toward him eagerly, and took the tid-bit from his hand. It was Fuzzy-Wuzz, his old friends not forgotten, though he had taken to the wild where he belonged.

THE END

Transcriber's Notes

Obvious typographical errors have been silently corrected. Variations in hyphenation and accents have been standardised but all other spelling and punctuation remains unchanged.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK FUZZY-WUZZ, A
LITTLE BROWN BEAR OF THE SIERRAS ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are

located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, "Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation."
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.
- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project

Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to

you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the

efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment

including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a

copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility:
www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.